

英语导游带团素材集锦

Hello, China

1. Introduction to China

进英语导游备考/从业群加微：ddzls57

The ancient Yellow River flows uninterrupted from east to west for thousands of years. Silk was made into cloth, while clay was made into pottery and ceramics. Millions of stones were piled into the Great Wall. The country created many wonders, such as the Great Wall, Mega Grottoes in Dunhuang, Terracotta Warriors and Chinese Kung Fu. Beijing is the capital of Zhongguo,

China, which opens to and embraces the world. The Beijing Olympic Games 2008, and the Shanghai World Expo 2010 were held here in Zhongguo. Peking Opera and Western Opera are performed on the same stage. Cultures of the whole world show brilliant vitality in this ancient country. This is Zhongguo. Hope you can understand her, appreciate her and love her. All the Chinese people, Black-eyed and yellow-skinned welcome you with open arms.

一条古老的黄河贯穿东西，流淌千年。蚕丝制成服装，黏土烧成陶瓷，石头垒出万里长城。这个国度创造了很多奇迹，长城、敦煌莫高窟、兵马俑、功夫。北京是中国的首都，它开放国门走向现代。2008年奥运会、2010年上海世博会在中国召开。京剧和歌剧在这里同台，世界文化在这里同放异彩。这就是中国！希望你了解她，欣赏她，爱上她。所有黄皮肤、黑眼睛的中国人都张开双臂热情的欢迎你。

2. Ni Hao

Ni hao is the most commonly used greeting. Kong Qiu, or Confucius, told people 2,500 years ago that everyone must follow etiquette. So, China is called the 'home of etiquette'. Ni hao is the most typical greeting in China wishing you well. A greeting that wishes you good health, a good job and a happy family. Let's say that together: 'Ni hao!'. Ni hao!

你好，是一句最常用的问候语。2500年前，中国人的道德先驱孔子告诉他的人民要遵守礼仪之道。故而，中国被称作礼仪之邦。你好，就是这个礼仪之邦最具中国色彩的问候语，可以祝福一切美好的事物。当中国人在跟你说“你好”的时候，已经包含了诸如：身体健康、工作顺利、阖家欢乐的美好寓意。让我们一起来说：“你好！”

3. Confucious and Chinese Philosophy

Born in 551 BC, Confucius, Kong Zi, has made the greatest contribution to Chinese culture of anyone in history. Although he was raised in a poor family, he visited famous scholars and learned a lot. He developed his thoughts into a system of philosophy known as Confucianism. Confucianism emphasized self-cultivation, harmonious relationships with each other and respect for the elderly.

Friends should be honest to each other. Rulers should make an effort to provide a happy life for people. He was a great teacher as well and promoted education for ordinary people. He traveled around to promote his political thinking but failed. But he never gave up. Kong Zi is a great Chinese spiritual leader. Over the last 2,000 years, his philosophy has continued to influence China and the rest of the world. It is also regarded as the symbol of oriental culture.

孔子出生于公元前551年，是历史上对中华文化影响最大的人。他出生贫寒，为了求学遍访名师。后来，他创立了儒家思想。儒家思想注重人的自我修养，强调与人建立和谐的关系，对待长辈要尊敬有礼，与朋友交往要诚实守信。统治者应该致力于让人民生活幸福。孔子还是一位伟大的老师，他倡导“有教无类”，每个人都有受教育的权利。孔子周游列国推行他的政治思想，但未能成功，可是他从不放弃。孔子，是华夏民族精神上的引领者。2000多年来，孔子的思想影响着中国乃至世界，成为东方文化的一种象征。

4. Sun Tzu The Ultimate Master of War

Sun Tzu, who lived in China during the Spring and Autumn Period, is regarded as the ultimate master of war. His great military work, The Art of War, has been read for more than 2,000 years. Sun Tzu believed that competition between economies and logistics is the nature of war.

Only if the nation is prosperous and its people are strong enough will they win the war, otherwise the war will bring huge damages to the nation and people. Gathering information on your enemies is the key to winning wars. The victorious general must be familiar with his enemies just as with himself and direct troops according to the newest situation. The supreme art of war is to subdue the enemy without force. His spirit reminds us that peace is the common objective we should pursue.

春秋时期的中国，孙子被誉为兵圣。他写了一部流传了 2000 多年的军事论著---《孙子兵法》。孙子主张战争制胜的本质是经济和后勤上的较量。国富民强才能取得战争的胜利，否则会给本国人民带来巨大的伤害。战争制胜的关键是要收集敌军的信息，要像熟悉自己一样熟悉敌人，随时根据敌人的行动改变作战部署。战争制胜的最高境界是不战而屈人之兵。现在，孙子的思想依然提醒着我们，和平才是人类的共同目标。

5. Lao Tzu The Father of Chinese Philosophy

Kong Qiu (Confucius) , the historical Chinese saint, is considered to be the greatest teacher of China. His teacher was Lao Tzu. Kong Qiu said that Lao Tzu was a dragon who hid in the clouds. He learned from Lao Tzu all his life but could not understand all his great wisdom. 2,500 years later, his work has been translated into many foreign languages.

Lao Tzu believed that people should learn from nature and keep a harmonious relationship with nature. Beside a river, Lao Tzu told Kong Tzu that a saint should act like flowing water. Water gives life to others but does not fight with others. A saint makes no error and no one hates him. Therefore, he can make great achievements. In China, Lao Tzu is considered the elite of teachers.

东方圣人孔子，被中国人称为最伟大的老师。他的老师就是老子。孔子称颂老子像一条神龙，隐藏在云雾之中。孔子用一辈子的时间跟他学习，也不能完全领悟他的伟大和智慧。2500 年后，老子的著作成为被翻译成最多语言的中国读物。老子认为人类要向自然学习，注意保持天地万物的和谐发展。在黄河边，老子告诉孔子，圣人应当像眼前的流水；水善于滋养万物，而不与万物争夺利益。所以，圣人没有过失，也没有人来怨恨他，他才能成就大业。在中国，老子被认为是师祖。

6. Sun and Chinese solar terms

Sun, tài yáng, brings light and vitality to the world. Legends say that there were ten tài yáng in the sky in ancient times. People couldn't put up with the hot weather brought by ten tài yáng. A hero named Houyi shot down nine tài yáng with his bow. The Chinese created a calendar according to shadows produced by the last tài yáng. The Chinese have created 24 solar terms according to the circulation laws of tài yáng. They are used to guide farming activities. The rise and set of tài yáng represents hope in the hearts of Chinese people.

太阳为人类世界带来了光明和生机。传说在中国的远古时代，天上曾经有十个太阳。人们难以忍受这样的高温，英雄后裔挺身而出，用弓箭射掉了九个太阳。根据对太阳光影的测量，中国人创立了自己的历法。中国人还根据太阳的运行规律，制定了二十四节气；依靠它来指导农田耕作。日升日落，太阳代表着中国人心中的希望。

7 Moon and its significance in Chinese culture

This character means moon with wax and wane. Mythical meanings are attributed to yue liang in Chinese legends. Legend has it, that Chang'e the wife of Ancient Chinese hero Hou Yi, stole her husband's elixir and ate it. Then she became a fairy and flew to the yue liang. She lived alone on the yue liang with only the company of a rabbit. Worshipping yue liang is an ancient custom in China. A round yue liang represents family reunion and often reminds people of their family. An ancient Chinese poem says, raise my eyes to the yue liang, lower my head and think of home.

月亮这个形象意味着月圆月缺。在中国，月亮被赋予了许多神话色彩。传说，后裔的妻子嫦娥偷吃了丈夫的仙丹，独自飞上天成仙了。她孤独地生活在月亮上，只有一只兔子陪伴。在中国，有祭拜月亮的习俗。圆圆的月亮又象征着团圆，人们看到

8 Chinese Lunar Calendar Introduction

The lunar calendar(nong li) is the traditional Chinese calendar and is often used in agriculture. According to nong li, the crescent appears on the first day of each month and full moon comes out at the middle of the month. The cycle lasts for about 30 days. 24 days mark 24 divisions of the solar year in nong li, according to the different positions of the Sun.

For example, the division 'Lichun' or 'the beginning of Spring', reminds people that Spring is coming. 'Jingzhe' or 'the walking of insects' means that the weather is getting warmer. 'Lixia' or 'the beginning of Summer' is the point that crops are blooming. 'Dahan' or 'the great cold' is the end of severe Winter. All these create a circle. Year after year people experience the mysteries of nature with nong li.

农历是中国的传统历法，农业上使用的历书。新月是农历一个月的第一天，满月到了，就是农历的月中。这样循环一个月，大概要 30 天。农历，又根据太阳的位置，设立了二十四节气。立春，提醒人们开始进入了春天。惊蛰时，天气渐渐暖和，小虫子都出来活动。立夏，农作物开始旺盛地生长。大寒以后，天气逐渐暖和了。至此，地球绕太阳公转了一周，完成了一个循环。一年又一年，人们根据农历观察自然，体会大自然的神秘。

9 The Chinese compass and explorer Zheng He

A compass, zhǐ nán zhēn, indicates north and south. It was invented by Chinese 2,000 years ago. The ancient zhǐ nán zhēn looked like a spoon. When the spoon was put on the plate, its handle could point to the south using magnetic fields. Then Chinese used a little steel needle to replace the spoon. This made the zhǐ nán zhēn easier to carry.

Six hundred years ago, Zheng He, a famous eunuch of the Ming Dynasty, traveled to Southeast Asia and the Indian Ocean seven times. Zheng even reached the Red Sea with the help of the zhǐ nán zhēn. The invention boosted the development of navigation.

指南针可以指示南北。2000 多年前，中国人发明了它。古代的指南针就像一把汤勺；把它放在平滑的盘子上，依靠磁铁的原理，当它静止的时候，勺柄就会指向南方。后来，中国人用小钢针代替了汤勺，指南针就更轻便了。600 多年前，郑和先后七下西洋，最远到达红海沿岸与非洲东海岸，便是依靠指南针的导航。指南针的出现促进了世界航海时代的发展。

10 Gunpowder An explosive Chinese invention

Gunpowder (huo yao) is another ancient Chinese invention. It was invented by accident. More than 1,000 years ago, people experimenting in a pharmacy made the discovery. They found that if sulphur, charcoal and potassium nitrate were mixed together with a certain proportion, the mixture would explode. Gunpowder changed the style of wars.

The steel age ended and gunpowder-based weapons are now widely used. More than 600 years ago, primitive guns were used in China. Cannon balls were propelled by the thrust of the huo yao explosion. Now, huo yao is also widely used in fireworks. The splendid fireworks at the Beijing Olympic Games garnered wide acclaim and admiration from the audience.

火药是中国的一项古老发明。它的发明很偶然。1000 多年前，人们在尝试制造各种药物的过程中，偶然发现将硫磺、木炭、硝石以一定的比例混合，便生产出火药。火药使作战方式发生变革，从冷兵器开始向火器发展。600 多年前，中国便有了原始火炮，利用火药燃烧产生的推力发射炮弹。今日的火药广泛应用于烟火。2008 年北京奥运会上，无数绽放在空中的美丽烟火，令人惊叹不已，带给人全新的美感。

11 Paper Chinese inventions

Paper, zhi, was a Chinese invention. 2,000 years ago, Chinese invented paper-making. This zhi

was made of silk and was so expensive that only the emperor and aristocrats could afford to use it. 1,900 years ago, a eunuch called Cai Lun improved the paper-making process. He made cheap jinzhi out of tree bark and rags. The improvement in paper-making spread zhi far and wide, and many different types of zhi were invented by Chinese people. Xuan paper, a kind of high quality rice paper, best shows the charm of traditional Chinese painting and calligraphy. Jute paper is used to transcribe Chinese classics. Later, Chinese zhi spread to the West via the Chinese Silk Road. Thousands of years of culture and civilization were recorded on zhi, and passed to different parts of the world.

纸的发明源于中国。2000 多年前，中国人发明了造纸术。这种纸用蚕丝作原料，价格昂贵，只有皇帝和贵族才能使用。1900 多年前，一个叫蔡伦的人改进了造纸术。他利用树皮、破布，造出了轻便又廉价的纸。造纸术的改进使纸广为流传，也出现了很多品种。宣纸最能展示中国画的魅力。黄麻纸多用来书写中国古老的经书。后来，中国的纸经过丝绸之路传向西方。千百年来，文明被记录在纸上，传递到世界各地。

12 Invention of printing

A Chinese named Bi Sheng invented movable type print around 1,000 years ago. The movable components are cubes made of baked clay. Characters were carved on each piece of clay, which looked like the seals widely used in China. The movable components could be arranged freely to form different vocabularies and sentences. They were fixed on an iron plate with frames in certain sequence. Then ink was painted and a piece of paper was laid down. A printed sheet was created this way. This technique improved the efficiency of printing and transformed traditional transcription into modern printing. Scripts and paintings spread widely in the world with the help of yìn shuā.

大约 1000 年前，中国人毕昇发明了活字印刷术。活字，就是一个个用胶泥制成的立方体毛坯。每个胶泥块上都雕刻着一个汉字，就像中国人常用的印章。活字之间，可以灵活地排列组合、组词造句。印刷时，用带框的四方形铁板做底托，把活字一个个排进框内；刷上墨，盖上纸，排列整齐的印刷品就这样诞生了。毕昇发明的活字印刷术，大大提高了印刷的效率，让传统的手工抄写发展成为批量印刷。文字、图画借助印刷术更加快速广泛地传播到世界各地。

13 Peking opera

Jingju, or Peking opera, is an ancient performance art with a history of 200 years. Jingju has four kinds of roles according to different identities and personalities. The lyrics of jingju are performed with swinging or rhythmic speaking, accompanied by dozens of musical instruments. Now, jingju still enchants many Chinese people and foreigners with its unique charm.

京剧是一个有着 200 多年历史的古老戏曲。按照人物的身份、性格，京剧把所有角色分为四类。京剧的台词使用歌唱或富有音乐性的念白。用于京剧伴奏的乐器有几十种。今天，京剧依然用它独特的魅力让很多人着迷。

14 Traditional Chinese painting

Red, green, black, white, heavy, light, dry and wet changes of water and ink on paper show the mysteries of traditional Chinese painting, guo hua. Tools and materials involve writing brushes, ink, colored ink, rice paper and silk. The hardness or softness of brushes, paper absorbency and color determine the features of guo hua. Water, ink and lines are the most essential factors for guo hua. Unlike Western paintings, guo hua doesn't use three dimensions or realism. Instead, paintings involve a unique Chinese view of scenery. It's very common that a Chinese painting is attached with a poem. If you understand guo hua you will have a better understanding of Chinese people.

红、绿、黑、白、浓、淡、干、湿，水墨在纸上的变化显示着中国画的奥秘。绘画的工具和材料通常有毛笔、墨、颜料、宣纸、绢等。毛笔的软硬，纸张对于水分的吸收，颜料的色彩表现都充分影响了中国画的特征。中国画注重水墨与线条。和西

万油画比较起来，中国画不追求立体和写实。这是因为中国人观看景物有自己的独特方式。国画画面上常伴有诗句。了解了中国画也就了解了中国人。

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15 Chinese frescoes

Chinese frescoes date back to the prehistoric period some 10,000 years ago. People carved images of human activities and natural views on rocks. Excavated from tombs built 2,200 years ago, the bi hua remains clear, vivid and colorful. Legend has it that an ancient painter drew a dragon on the wall and when he added eyes to the drawing the image turned into a real dragon. With the introduction of Buddhism to China, bi hua on the subject of religion rapidly developed. The bi hua, or frescoes, in the Dunhuang Mogao Grottoes are the most famous ones in China. They are a collection of masterpieces of numerous painters in the past 1,000 years. They tell historical tales and religious stories.

中国壁画最早可追溯到距今一万年前的史前时期。人们在岩壁上刻画下人类活动与自然景物。2200 多年前，中国古墓出土的壁画，线条流畅、色彩艳丽、形象生动。传说古代有位画家在墙壁上画的龙十分神似，待画上眼睛之后竟然变成真龙。后来佛教传入中国，宗教壁画迅速发展。中国最出名的壁画群在敦煌莫高窟。它是无数画匠千余年来的杰作，集中描绘了宗教、历史、故事与传说。

16 Dance

Scenes of dancing were drawn on pottery in China some 5,000 years ago. At that time, people danced at ceremonies for worship. There was a concubine who could dance on a tray in the imperial palace about 2,000 years ago. She danced so lightly that she supposedly would fly away when the wind blew. Legends say that an emperor made his soldiers dance when he returned in triumph. The dance was powerful and vigorous. People also dance on festivals, celebrations and weddings. You can see abundant styles of wu dao in China, a country composed of many ethnic groups. Wu dao shortens the distance between people.

5000 年前，陶器上就记载了中国人舞蹈的画面。那时，人们在祭祀的时候跳舞。大约 2000 年前的中国宫廷，有一位皇妃能在托盘中跳舞，好像风一吹就要飞了。历史上还有一位皇帝，每当凯旋归来的时候，就让士兵跳舞庆祝胜利，这种舞蹈刚劲有力。人们也在节日、丰收、结婚等喜庆的节日里跳舞。中国是多民族融合的国家，在这里你能看到丰富多彩的舞蹈。舞蹈，让人和人之间的距离更近了。

17 Chinese Music

Chinese music originated from nature. The sounds of the wind blowing through the trees, birds chirping and water flowing are the inspiration of Chinese yin yue. Xun, an ancient egg-shaped instrument made of pottery, can imitate the sound of the wind by blowing through the holes. The bone flute, which was made 8,000 years ago, could also imitate the sounds of nature.

There were 125 instruments in the private orchestra of a noble more than 2,000 years ago, according to archaeological findings. Various categories make up Chinese yin yue, some involving more modern elements. However, the natural beauty of Chinese yin yue has endured from classic styles to the modern form classic styles to the modern compositions.

中国音乐来自自然。风吹过树林的声音、鸟叫的声音、水流的声音都启发了中国音乐。用陶土制成的埙，可以发出风吹洞穴的声音。8000 年前的骨笛，也在模仿自然界的声音。考古发现在 2000 多年前一个贵族家里的乐队有 125 件乐器，规模巨大。中国音乐发展到现在种类丰富，今天中国音乐融合进去了更多现代元素。然而，从古典到现代，始终未变的是它的自然之美。

18 Traditional Chinese chime bells Bianzhong

Chime bells, bian zhong, are the most majestic and holy ancient instrument in China. As a symbol of power, they were used for sacrificial ceremonies or other crucial ceremonies,

starting 3,500 years ago. Bian zhong were composed of bells with different scales. The bells are played by mallets and create the sounds of seven musical scales, much like the piano. What's more amazing is that one bell can generate two notes when struck at different spots. This set of bian zhong was discovered in the tomb of an ancient monarch. The ancient treasure finally saw the light of day. Its exquisite cast and pure sound revealed the high level of ancient Chinese civilization and wisdom.

说到中国的古代乐器，最为庄严神圣、气势宏伟的非编钟莫属。编钟出现于 3500 年前的中国，它经常在祭祀、战争等重大庆典时演奏，是贵族权利的象征。编钟是由大小不同的铜钟组成，用木槌敲击能发出与钢琴上七个音阶几乎相等的乐音。更为惊奇的是，敲击编钟不同的部位，能发出两个音调。这套编钟是在中国古代一个国君的墓葬中发现的。尘封了几千年的瑰宝得以与世人相见。它的铸造之精美，音质之纯正体现了中国古人的智慧与文明。

19 Gu Qin Chinese musical instrument

Long long ago, a person was playing gu qin. A woodcutter heard the song and said, "I feel the mountains and rivers in the music". The player was happy that man understood what is in his heart and made friends with him. The body of gu qin is made of wood and the strings are made of silk. Playing gu qin in an elegant environment brings people back to nature.

Playing gu qin can purify the soul. It represents wisdom, talent and emotion. In 1977, a recording of Flowing Water was broadcasted on the Voyage 1 and Voyager 2 spacecrafts in outer space.

古时，有一个人在弹琴，一个打柴人听过之后说：“我感受到高山和江河”。弹琴人很高兴有人能听懂他的心，于是他们成为了朋友。古琴以木为体，蚕丝为弦。在优雅的环境里弹琴，能让人回归自然。弹奏古琴可以使人内心安宁，净化自己的灵魂。在中国人的眼里，古琴是一种才智、才艺和才情的化身。在 1977 年，中国古琴曲《流水》通过太空探测器旅行之 1 号和 2 号，传向外太空。

20 Calligraphy

Chinese calligraphy(shu fa) refers to writing art and techniques with writing brushes. 1,600 years ago, a boy named Wang Xizhi worked hard at calligraphy. He washed his writing brushes in a pool and the pool turned black. Eventually he became a prominent calligrapher in China. Writing brushes, Chinese inks, rice paper and ink slabs are the basic tools of calligraphy.

Proper technique for handling the writing brushes and maintaining the proper angle between the tips of brushes and the paper are required. The structure of each individual character and overall arrangement are both important. Calligraphers have created plenty of masterpieces which have been passed from generation to generation. One of the masterpieces is the "Orchid Pavilion Preface" by Wang Xizhi. Shu fa represents the aesthetic taste and philosophy of Chinese scholars.

中国书法，通常是指用毛笔书写的艺术和技法。1600 多年前的王羲之勤练书法，他涮洗毛笔的墨汁把池塘都染成了黑色。后来他成为了中国最受尊崇的书法家。笔、墨、纸、砚是书法的基本工具。书法讲究握笔的姿势，注意笔尖和纸的角度，也讲究单个字的结构和整体布局。几千年里，书法家们创作了诸多传世名作，王羲之的《兰亭集序》便是其中之一。可以说，书法蕴含着中国文人的审美情趣和人生哲学。

21 Chinese writing brush

More than 2,000 years ago, a general returned from hunting and was inspired by the tail of a rabbit. He cut off the tail and stuck it into a bamboo drain, making the first writing brush. The pen holder is made of bamboo or bone, the nib is made hairs from sheep, rabbits or wolves. Unlike other writing tools, it is difficult to write with writing brushes.

Writing han zi with soft mao bi represents oriental philosophy. It is regarded as a method to cultivate the mind and nature, and widely used among scholars. Writing became an art called

calligraphy with the birth of maobi. Mao bi is a friend of Chinese scholars making records of their knowledge and character.

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一位狩猎归来的将军，他把兔尾剪下插入竹管，从此第一支毛笔诞生了。它用竹子或兽骨作为笔杆，把羊、兔或狼的毛捆扎成圆而尖的毛束作为笔头。在其他书写工具中只有毛笔的质地是软的，这为书写增加了难度。用柔软的毛笔写方正的汉字正符合了东方的哲学精神。中国文人用毛笔写字来磨砺意志。毛笔的诞生让写字成为了一门艺术，即书法。毛笔像一位朋友一样陪伴在中国文人的身边，记录和见证着他们的学识与品格。

22 Journey to the West

Journey to the West is the most famous mythology in China. It was inspired by real historical events. A Buddhist monk named Xuanzang walked through the desert for more than 10,000 kilometers on his pilgrimage to India to obtain Buddhist sutra. His first disciple, named Sun Wukong, is a monkey with great magical powers. He is a righteous and brave hero who has mastered 72 methods of transformation.

Unlike conventional heroes, it departs from tradition and fights for freedom. His tag is, "Hey, I'm coming!". He defeated powerful demons on the pilgrimage and helped Xuanzang accomplish his objective with Zhu Bajie and monk Sha Wujing. The pilgrimage represents the discipline of Buddhism. Journey to the West tells stories about self-discipline and overcoming difficulties. It has a profound influence on the Chinese spirit.

《西游记》是中国最出名的神话，它源于一段真实的历史。在公元 605 年，有个叫玄奘的僧人穿过严酷的沙漠行走一万多公里来到印度求取真经。唐僧的大徒弟孙悟空是一只神通广大的猴子。它正义、勇敢、会七十二变是西游记中真正的大英雄。和传统的英雄不一样，孙悟空勇于反抗、追求自由。它的口头禅是：“俺老孙来也！”在取经的路上，他降妖除魔，与猪八戒、沙僧一起帮助唐僧最终到达西域，取得真经。取经之路，正代表一个人的修行过程。《西游记》中不断超越自我、克服困难的故事一直影响着中国人。

23 Bamboo in Chinese culture

The plant that best represents the spirit of Chinese scholars is bamboo, zhu. Chinese value the character of zhu. We can see its wild and intractable style from its erect shape and integrity from its straight joints. We can see tenacity in its unbendable branches. Chinese scholars treat zhu as their spiritual support, saying that they could live without eating meat but not without zhu growing around their houses. Zhu is everywhere in Chinese daily life. You feel peaceful and at ease with zhu around.

有种植物最能代表中国文人的精神追求，这就是竹。中国人看中竹的品质，从它挺直的身形，看出桀骜不驯的风骨。它不断向上生长的竹节，看出气节；它不易弯曲的特征，看出坚韧。中国文人把竹当做精神寄托，宁可食无肉，不可居无竹。竹子在中国人的生活中无处不在。身处竹林你可以感受到它的飘逸自然、素雅、宁静。

24 Dragons A Chinese symbol of power

Chinese dragons with no wings are different from Western ones. They are lucky animals that can bring a good year for people. Dragons are regarded as a symbol of power and royal dignity in China. The images of loong can be seen in the Forbidden City and the Summer Palace. They are admired by people and represent Chinese spirits.

There are two festivals involving loong. On the Lantern Festival, each January 15th on the lunar calendar, people wave dragon lanterns to celebrate the coming spring. On the Dragon Boat Festival, on the 5th day of the 5th lunar month, people hold dragon boat competitions. Loong is a powerful symbol in Chinese culture.

与西方的龙不同，中国的龙既没有翅膀，也很少喷火。它是一种能带来风调雨顺的吉祥之兽。在古代，龙还是皇权的象征。在故宫、颐和园里都可以看到各种威武神奇的龙的形象。在民间，人们尊崇龙的精神，把龙当做中华民族的象征。中国每年

25 Phoenix King of birds

Legends say that there is a huge beautiful bird with colorful feathers and a beautiful voice, which dances elegantly. It is regarded as the 'queen of birds'. It brings a peaceful and auspicious atmosphere when he shows up. This is the phoenix, fenghuang. According to the records of ancient China, celebrations were held after conquering floods.

Fenghuang danced to the music during the ceremony, therefore, it is regarded as an auspicious bird. Dragons and fenghuang are usually mentioned together in China. Dragons represent masculinity and fenghuang represent elegance, harmony and auspiciousness. Legends of fenghuang are passed from generation to generation.

传说，有一种美丽巨大的神鸟，它有着五彩羽毛、动人歌声和优雅舞姿。它被尊为百鸟之王。它出现时，万物笼罩在安宁祥和的氛围中。这就是凤凰。中国古书记载，古人治理洪水后，国家举行庆典，乐曲声中凤凰翩翩起舞；于是它被认为是一种预示吉祥的鸟。在中国，龙和凤常常被同时提起。龙象征阳刚霸气，凤则象征柔美高贵、和谐、吉祥。凤凰的传说在民间代代相传。

26 Kung Fu The Oriental Martial Art

Kung fu (gong fu) is as fast as wind, as stable as mountains and as powerful as fire. Kung fu originated from labor and the imitation of animals. Knives, swords, spears, sticks and bows are used in kung fu. Kung fu is not only useful, but also graceful. Therefore, kung fu is regarded as the Oriental martial art. It is not mysterious, everyone can take training. Kung fu is good for health and self-defense. Now, kung fu is widely practiced around the world.

像风一样快，像山一样稳，像火一样猛烈，这就是中国功夫。功夫起源于人们的劳动，同样来源于对动物的模仿。功夫拥有悠久的历史，包括了刀、枪、剑、棍、弓、拳等多种技艺。功夫不仅实用，招式也很优美。因此，功夫也被称为东方的搏击艺术。功夫并不神秘，每个人都能习练它。既能强身健体，又能自我防卫。如今，功夫已经传播至世界各地。

27 Tai chi quan Internal Chinese martial art

The yin yang philosophy of tai ji quan includes static dynamic, fast and slow. Chinese believe that dynamic is contained in static, and fast is contained in slow. Tai chi is the combination of these energies. It's fighting principle is to maneuver the internal energy flows to achieve speed and power. The most important function of tai chi is to experience the theory of static and dynamic in nature and life, and tune one's heart and figure in harmony with nature.

太极拳的阴阳哲学包含动与静、快与慢。中国人认为动蕴含在静里，快蕴含在慢中；太极就是这两种能量的总和。太极拳的搏击原理是调动人体内在的能量流动，既有速度又有爆发力。体会生命，体会自然中动与静的真正原理，在内心和身体上与自然保持和谐才是太极的最大用途。

28 Chinese sword

If you want to select a gentlemanlike weapon, the sword jian is the best choice. In ancient times, jian was a symbol of social status. Nobles not only had to study cultural knowledge but also swordsmanship. A good jian is cast using complicated procedures. Chinese like to compare the jian with mysterious things, like dragons, thunder and lightning. Chinese also like to protect justice, equality and other dreams of a better future using jian. Jian is a weapon but swordsmanship is an art.

如果从冷兵器中选出一位绅士那一定非剑莫属。在古代，剑是身份地位的象征。贵族不仅要学习文化，还要学习剑术。铸造一把好剑需要复杂的工艺。中国人喜欢把宝剑比作龙、雷、闪电等具有神秘感的事物，也用剑捍卫仁义、善良、公平这些美好的梦想。剑是武器，剑术是一种艺术。

29 Traditional Chinese medicine

Traditional Chinese medicine, zhong yi, is a therapy and a theory on how to stay healthy. Diagnosis in zhong yi comes from various forms of observation, including visual, auditory, olfactory, tactile and questioning. The doctor observes a patient's tongue, voice, inquires about the patient's habits and medical history and feels the patient's pulse to make a diagnosis. Therapies in zhong yi, emphasize tactile stimulation.

Doctors give massage. Tools for Gua Sha and cupping are easily found in daily life. Herbal medicines are selected from natural plants and are processed to cure different diseases. Zhong yi prescribes to the belief that the human body has its own functioning system. People are healthy as long as their body system remains balanced.

中医是中国传统的医疗方法和养生理论。望闻问切是中国特有的诊断方法；观察舌头的颜色，听患者语言气息的强弱，询问生活习惯和病史，用手指按住手腕上的脉搏体察它跳动的频率以观察病情。注重自然接触是中医治疗的特点，推拿是中医用手直接治病。刮痧和拔罐所用的工具也都是生活中随处可取的。中草药是从自然植物中选材，经过加工处理，通过多种搭配来治疗很多病症。中医认为人体是一个整体，只要做到整体平衡，人体就是健康的。

30 Acupuncture and Moxibustion

Acupuncture, which is called zhen jiu in Chinese, is a medical treatment that originated in China. Zhen means "needles that pierce one's body". Jiu means 'moxibustion', a special treatment in traditional Chinese medicine. Plant leaves were once used to smoke certain parts of the human body. Traditional Chinese medicine describes the energy flow within the human body as a network. It is called jingluo.

The major nodes on the network are called xue wei or an acupuncture point. Traditional Chinese doctors believe that stimulating the xue wei can promote energy circulation and expel illness. For example, having zhen jiu on zu san li can promote digestion and having zhen jiu an nei guan is good for one's heart. Chinese people have been using this medical treatment for thousands of years. The tiny needles reveal the mysteries of human body.

针灸是中国所特有且神奇的治疗方法。针，直接刺入皮肉；灸，用植物的叶子来熏烤身体的特定部位。中医把人体内的能量流通描述成网络的状态，并叫它“经络”。经络上的主要节点叫做穴位。中医认为，针灸在穴位上的刺激能调动体内能量循环，从而排除疾病。比如，针灸足三里穴位有健脾等多种作用。针灸内关穴位对心脏会有疗效。中国人使用这种治疗方法已经有几千年了。小小的针灸即打开了人体庞大的内部信息。

31 Spring Festival and its colorful traditions

Spring Festival, Chun Jie is the first day of the Chinese lunar calendar. When Chun Jie is approaching people are busy purchasing good, cleaning the house, cooking traditional food, making Spring Festival couplets, and hanging spring festival pictures. Having a family dinner is the main activity on Chun Jie. Dumplings are essential to the dinner.

Dumplings represent reunion and goodwill. The whole family gathers to enjoy quality family time. On Chun Jie, Lunar New Year's Day, people in new clothes visit each other, and give money to kids to send good wishes. During Chun Jie holidays all kinds of celebrations are held, including temple fairs, performances, and lantern exhibitions which lasts nearly half a month.

春节是中国传统历法确定的一年中的第一天。临近春节时，人们忙着采购物品，清扫房屋，做各种传统食物，贴春联，贴年画。春节最重要的内容是吃团圆饭。饺子是必不可少的，它代表团圆吉祥，一家人围坐在一起享受亲情带来的温暖。春节当天，人们都换上了新衣服走亲访友，孩子们会收到长辈给的钱，保佑平安。逛庙会，演节目，闹花灯庆祝活动持续半月左右。这就是中国的春节。

32 Qingming Festival

The Qing Ming festival is a day of reverence for Chinese. People hold ceremonies for ancestors, and sweep their tombs on April 5th every year. According to tradition, during the Tomb Sweeping, people put food in front of the tombs, add new soil on the tomb. Decorate the tombs with some fresh branches and knock head.

A traditional Chinese painting named Riverside Scene on the Qing Ming festival, drawn nine hundred years ago, shows the prosperous atmosphere and activities on that day. People returned from Tomb Sweeping with horses and packages in the picture. Now it is a public holiday in China. Although ceremonies have changed a little with time. Chinese still express their grief for the deceased.

清明节是中国的祭祀节日。在每年的四月五点左右，人们祭祖和扫墓。按照旧时习俗，扫墓时人们来到墓地，将食物供祭，在亲人墓前，为坟墓培上新土；折几支嫩绿的新枝插在坟上，然后叩头拜祭。900多年前的一幅中国画《清明上河图》描绘了当时人们在过清明节时的繁荣景象和节日风俗。人们骑着马、挑着担，从扫墓的地方归来。现在，清明节已经成为中国的法定假日。虽然随着时间的推移，祭祀的习俗可能稍稍改变，但中国人依然会在清明节这天伴随着春天的细雨，用自己的方式寄托对故人的哀思。

33 Dragon Boat Festival and its tragic origins

In ancient time, there was a great poet called Qu Yuan. He couldn't bear the anguish when his mother land was invaded, so he drowned himself in the river. Local residents rode boats to salvage and drop the rice balls into the river to distract fishes' attention from Qu's body. Later people memorialized Qu's patriotism by rowing and making Zongzi on the Dragon Boat Festival, Duanwujie.

That's how the tradition of dragon boat racing and eating Zongzi were started. A nation practice on Duanwujie is to put wormwood on the front door to repel evil things. In some places people drink realgar wine and children wear sachet. Now the family gets together on Duanwujie. Nowadays people have a variety of other activities to celebrate this traditional festival.

在中国有位伟大的诗人叫屈原，他不忍看到祖国被侵略，投江而死。当地百姓划船捞救，还投米团来吸引鱼。后来，人们为了纪念他，每年端午节都会划船、包粽子，就有了赛龙舟和吃粽子的习俗。古时端午节的风俗是在门口挂药草以预防疾病，驱除不好的事情。有些地方还喝雄黄酒（药酒），小孩子戴香包。现在过端午节时常常是一家人团聚在一起。现在人们过端午节时还会以其他方式来度过这个传统节日。

34 Qixi Festival Chinese Valentine's Day

The Qixi Festival, also known as the Chinese Valentine's Day, falls on the seventh day of the seventh lunar month on the Chinese calendar. There's a romantic love story associated with Qixi. It says that a fairy named Zhi Nu, who lived in heaven, fell in love with a cow herder named Niu Lang during her trip to earth. Zhi Nu decided to settle down on earth and lead an ordinary life with Niu Lang.

However, love between ordinary people and fairy gods is forbidden. They were punished by the heavenly gods and turned into stars located on opposite sides of the galaxy, watching each other from the impassable distance. They are permitted to meet each other only on the seventh day of the seventh month each year. Magpies gather and make a bridge across the galaxy for them. Qixi is the most romantic one among all the traditional Chinese festivals. Chinese recall the loyalty of love and wish for happiness on the festival.

每年的农历七月七日是中国的情人节——七夕。关于七夕有一个浪漫的传说，仙女织女到人间游玩和人间的牛郎相爱了，织女决定在人间和牛郎过平凡却幸福的生活。神仙和凡人之间的爱情是不被允许的，他们遭到天界的惩罚，被化作牵牛星和织女星分隔在银河两岸，遥遥相望。每年只有在农历七月七日这一天才能相会。这天，喜鹊会飞到银河上搭起一座鹊桥，让他们团聚。七夕是中国传统节日中最浪漫的节日。这一天，中国人缅怀对爱情的忠贞，包含着对全家幸福的期许。

35 Mid-Autumn Festival

The Mid-Autumn Festival, Zhongqiujie, is a festival for families to get together in China. It falls on the 15th day of the 8th lunar month, when the full moon returns to the sky. On this day, people eat a moon-shaped dessert called a Moon Cake. All the family members sit together, eat Moon Cakes and fresh fruits, and enjoy the sight of the round and bright moon. Those who cannot return home look at the round moon and think of their family. Chinese people all around the world share the same tradition. Just like an ancient Chinese poem says, the moon was rising from the sea and all the people were sharing this moment.

在中国，中秋节是一个全家团圆的节日。按照中国的农历，每年八月十五月圆的那天就是中秋节。这一天，人们喜欢吃一种圆形的、像月亮一样的点心，叫做月饼；再配上新鲜的水果，一家人围坐在一起，欣赏天上又圆又亮的满月。就算是那些无法回家的人，也会在中秋节那天抬头望向那一轮圆圆的明月，寄托对故乡的思念。这是海内外所有中国人的共同情感，就像中国一首著名的诗里所说的：“海上生明月，天涯共此时。”

36 Water-Splashing Festival

The Dai ethnic group lives in south-eastern China's Yunnan Province. Each year they hold a grand festival called the Water-Splashing Festival (po shui jie). People dressed in beautiful clothes sing and dance and splash water on each other on the morning of the festival. Don't get angry if you are drenched; it represents a blessing.

More water means more good luck in the coming year. If a young man receives pouches made by a girl that means the girl has fallen in love with him. Po shui jie is regarded as the Valentine's Day for the Dai ethnic group. Po shui jie has become part of the culture in Yunnan Province. Nowadays, not only Dai people but also tourists participate in this exciting carnival.

在中国云南省有一个民族叫傣族，他们有一个盛大的节日叫泼水节。节日的一大早人们会穿上盛装，唱歌、跳舞、相互泼水。要是被泼的浑身湿透可千万不要生气，因为它代表着祝福；被泼的越多，新的一年就会越健康、幸福。如果是个小伙子，这一天可能会收到少女制作的荷包，那是她在向你表达爱意。原来，这泼水节还是傣族人的情人节。现在，泼水节成了云南的一道风景，不仅是傣族人，很多游客也会特意赶来，参加这个吉祥好玩的狂欢节。

37 Animals Signs of the Chinese zodiac

Europe has 12 constellations, while China has 12 animals symbolising the 12 branches used to designate years. The 12 animals finish a cycle every 12 years and each of them guards one year. Chinese believe that those who are born in a certain year would inherit the traits of the animal guarding that year. Rats are wise and cattle are hard-working.

Tigers are courageous and rabbits are prudent. Dragons are rich and respectful, and snakes are romantic. Horses are fast and a sheep is sincere. Monkeys are smart and flexible, while chickens are endowed with beauty. Dogs are faithful and pigs are amiable. Do you know what your symbolic animal denoting the year of your birth?

欧洲人有十二星座，中国人有十二生肖，后者以十二年为一个周期，以十二种动物轮流当班。中国人认为相应年份出生的人都有自己的特殊品质。老鼠代表智慧，牛代表勤奋，老虎代表勇猛，兔子代表谨慎，龙代表富贵，蛇代表浪漫，马代表速度，羊代表忠诚，猴子代表灵活，鸡代表美丽，狗代表忠诚，猪代表随和。你了解自己的属相吗？

38 A system of ancient Chinese knowledge

Feng shui is a mystical knowledge in China. People believe that the basic elements of things on the earth originated from air, water and land. The improvement of feng shui will improve the relationship between humans and nature. Feng shui is widely used in architecture and interior design. Chinese believe that the best houses should be integrated into nature. Water brings vitality and fish bring good luck. These elements determine the quality of feng shui. Feng shui involves medicine, architecture and philosophy. Chinese put emphasis on feng shui and the harmonious relationship between humans and nature. This is feng shui complicated and mysterious.

风水是中国非常神秘的一门学术。人们认为在地球上，万物的基础都来自于空气、水分和土地，改善风水，就是改善人与自然的关系。风水最多的用途是在建筑和布置家居。中国人认为最好的房子要融在大自然里。有水会带来生机和活力，有鱼会带来好运，这些都是决定风水好坏的因素。风水包含了医学、建筑学、哲学。中国人看中风水，看中人与自然的调和与平衡。它复杂而神秘，这就是风水。

39 Chinese Lion Dance

The performance that you just saw was the Lion Dance(wu shi), a Chinese traditional folk art. Lions are considered brave and auspicious in China. People perform wu shi on festivals to ward off bad luck and pray for a happy life. There are two dancers—one for the head and one for the rear. They cooperate with each other to make the different gestures of the lion.

“I hold the head, and it is a tiring job. The performance is becoming more difficult”. The dancers must have basic martial arts training, therefore they can accomplish difficult maneuvers. Now wu shi is not only popular in China but also in any place where Chinese live. “If there’s a Lion Dance in your country, why not watch it?”

“刚才我表演的是舞狮，这是中国的一项民间艺术。”在中国，狮子是勇猛和吉祥的象征。每逢喜庆节日，人们都会舞狮来赶走晦气，以求生活幸福安宁。舞狮者有两人，狮头一人，狮尾一人。他们相互配合，做出狮子的各种形态动作。“啊，我拿的是狮子头，很累的，更难的还在后面呢！”舞狮者要具备一定的武术功底，只有技术高超的舞狮者才敢做出高难度的动作。现在，舞狮不仅是在中国流行，凡是有华人的地方，几乎都有舞狮表演。“如果你的国家有华人舞狮，不妨去看看吧。”

40 Door Gods Menshen

People paste pictures of Door Gods on their doors to avoid bad luck and pray for safety. Legends say that an emperor was harassed by demons. Two generals drove out the demons so the emperor was able to fall asleep. The emperor pasted pictures of these two generals on his door and the demons disappeared. People pray that these heroes will guard them from evil. Menshen signifies the beginning of a new year; they guard the home for Chinese.

在中国民间，人们用贴门神的方法来驱邪避鬼、祈求平安。相传，古时有位皇帝被恶鬼骚扰，两位武将夜夜护驾，皇帝才得以安寝。皇帝命画匠绘制二人的图像贴在门口，恶鬼从此消失。现在，人们贴门神已经变成贴年画，以求获得好运和吉祥。门神预示着新年的开始，守卫着中国人的家园。

41 Chinese wedding customs

Chinese wedding, hun li, were held grandly and elegantly at sunset thousands of years ago. Modern hun li are held more lively with more variation in style. There are many traditions in this multi-ethnic country. Displaying the Chinese character ‘xi’ and throwing a feast are quite common at hun li. The bride is her most beautiful on hun li.

The tailored costumes range from cheongsam to Western-style gowns and veils. The bride and bridegroom exchange rings with each other, which represent vows of love. They accomplish the most important ceremony in their life, hun li, with the blessing of family and friends.

在两三千年以前，中国的婚礼更多是在黄昏举行，整个仪式庄重、典雅。现在的婚礼形式更多，场面也更加热闹。中国是个多民族的国家，民族多，婚礼的习俗也多。现在，在民间婚礼大多要贴喜字、摆宴席。婚礼的那天是新娘最漂亮的一天。新娘要穿上专门定制的几套衣服，从东方的旗袍到西式的婚礼。新郎与新娘还互戴上象征誓言的戒指，在亲朋的祝福下完成一生最重要的仪式之一，婚礼。

42 Chinese Cupid ---The Matchmaker

A matchmaker, often called hong niang in China, is a messenger of love. In a Chinese love story, a young man fell in love with a rich lady. The lady's family strongly objected to this marriage. The family's maid, named Hong Niang, persuaded the rich family to approve the marriage. There are many other stories about hong niang in Chinese literature and drama. Chinese are more than happy to be a hong niang because they believe those who bring happiness to others will be happy themselves. Now you understand that Hong Niang is the Chinese Cupid

在中国，红娘是爱情使者的代名词。这种说法来源于中国古代一个爱情故事，一位书生爱上一位富家小姐，但是小姐的母亲反对他们的爱情，小姐有位聪明伶俐的侍女叫做红娘，她劝解小姐的母亲，最终促成小姐和书生的美好姻缘。中国的文学、戏曲中有很多表现红娘故事的作品。生活中，也有很多人乐于当红娘，因为中国人相信给别人幸福，也会给自己带来幸福。现在，你明白了吧。红娘就是中国的丘比特。

43 Chrysanthemums in Chinese culture

Chrysanthemums bloom in the cold autumn air, representing elegance and courage in China. Chinese scholars speak highly of ju hua for their beauty and character. Ju hua also has another meaning. They are also used to convey grief for loved ones who have passed away. In addition, ju hua can be used as an ingredient for tea, wine and food. Festivals for ju hua are held annually in China. Ju hua blossoms remain open in late-autumn and winter when other flowers have withered.

在中国菊花代表高雅脱俗，因其在深秋不畏寒霜开放，深受中国古代文人的喜爱。有的咏其色，有的赞其姿，赋予菊花崇高、纯洁、坚强的品格。现实生活中，菊花还有另一层意义；人们在纪念逝去的亲人时，通常会用菊花寄托哀思。菊花不仅可供观赏，还可做茶、酿酒、做各种食物。中国每年都有菊花盛会。秋冬时节，万花凋零，只有菊花绽放。

44 Chinese etiquette

Etiquette, li, comes from the fear and respect of the nature in China. We find all the forms of li from heaven, earth and nature. Li represents the authority of emperors who was given by heaven. Li also represents hierarchy. In social life, li means that people get along with each other harmoniously and respect the elderly. Li comes from the heart of people, showing respect to heaven, the earth and people is important.

中国人对礼的认知首先来自于对大自然的敬畏。天、地、自然万物，从中我们发现了秩序，也找到了礼的格式。礼在官方，体现了皇权天授的威严。礼也体现了等级。礼在民间，人们和谐相处，长幼有序。发自内心的礼，在规矩之上，是中国人对天、地、人的敬重。

45 Number one Chinese scholar Zhuangyuan

If you have the chance to go back to ancient China and ask an educated man what his biggest dream was. He would tell you that he wants to become a zhuang yuan, a title conferred on the scholar who came first in the highest imperial examination. In ancient China, it was not that easy to be an official. You have to take exams first. The exams are very difficult and have many procedures. The outcome has to be confirmed by the Emperor himself. The number one scholar with the best score in the imperial exam is called zhuang yuan.

Once you are selected as zhuang yuan you will be appreciated by the Emperor and appear in a

parade downtown with a red robe and a tall, strong horse. Zhuang yuan is referred to the elite scholars. Now the imperial competitive examination has been cancelled for many years. However, people still like to call the best person in their field a zhuang yuan. An old saying goes that there are 360 trades and every trade has his master or zhuang yuan

如果你回到古代去问一个读书人，他最大的梦想是什么？那他多半会告诉你，中状元。在中国古代，想做官可不容易。你要先参加考试，考试很难，要层层选拔，最后还要皇帝亲自确认；最终成绩排在第一名的叫做状元。一旦考上状元可就风光啦，不仅会得到皇帝的赏识，还能穿红袍、骑大马在城里游行。所以，状元都是读书人中的精英。如今科举考试早就不存在了，但人们还是喜欢用状元来形容各行业的第一名。正如中国有句俗话：“三百六十行，行行出状元。”

46 Welcome to Beijing Chinese capital

The layout of Beijing formed in the 15th century. The imperial palace is the centre of the city's symmetrical layout. The 77-kilometre long axis is the symbol of Bei Jing. There are grand examples of Chinese architecture, such as the Imperial Palace, the Temple of Heaven and the Great Wall. Traditional folk arts, such as Peking Opera, and traditional foods, such as sugar-coated haws on a stick, and roast duck are famous worldwide. The Olympic Games was held here in 2008. While preserving its traditions, Beijing is becoming more and more open. Welcome to Beijing!

古都北京的布局形成于十五世纪，以故宫为中心对称建造。全长 7.7 公里的中轴线是北京的中心标志。北京有故宫、天坛、长城等宏大建筑。同时也有京剧等丰富的传统民间艺术；糖葫芦、烤鸭等多样的饮食文化。2008 年奥运会在这里成功举办，北京在保存传统的同时更加开放。北京欢迎您！

47 Great Wall of China

There is a long, stretching wall in China called the Great Wall, chang cheng. With a length of more than 5,000 kilometers, chang cheng was built continuously over more than 2,000 years by Chinese people. The watchtowers would be lit up by torches if a watchman spotted an enemy invasion. Messages could be passed to the military centre from on Watchtower to another. Chang cheng was expected to protect national peace. Constructing chang cheng would guard our own territory and we won't infringe on other people's territory. It is not only a brick wall, but also one of the world's greatest historical architectural works.

在中国有一道长长的城墙，它的名字叫长城。长城长一万多里，是中国人用了两千多年时间陆续建造的。古时，若有敌人进攻，烽火台会立即燃烧烟火，敌情便随着烟火一站站传向军事中心。中国古代修建长城是期望国家和平，修起一道道长长的城墙来守卫自家的土地，自己也不去侵犯别人的领地。长城它不仅仅是一道城墙，也是世界建筑的奇迹。

48 Imperial Palace

Legends say that there are 10,000 rooms in the palace of the emperor in heaven. The emperor in the real world built a palace with 9,999-and-a-half rooms to show his respect to the Heavenly Emperor. 600 years ago, 100,000 laborers were engaged in building the palace with 100 million bricks and 200 million tiles. The palace featured vermilion walls and gold-glazed tiles. The palace is open to the public and attracts crowds of tourists to experience royal life.

中国神话传说天上的皇帝有一座皇宫，它由一万个房间组成；于是人间帝王为了表示自己的谦恭，他的宫殿便减去了半间变成 9999 间半。600 年前，为了兴建这座世界最大的皇宫，使用了十万工匠、一亿块砖和两亿块瓦。深红色的宫墙和金黄色的琉璃瓦，是这座宫殿最引人注目的特征。今天的故宫门户大开，任何人都可以徜徉在昔日皇帝的庭院里，遥想神圣帝国的辉煌与荣耀。

49 Temple of Heaven

Emperors held annual ceremonies to pray to heaven for a good harvest at the Temple of Heaven,

Tiantan. It was built in Beijing in 1420. Emperors pray to heaven for good harvest. Ancient Chinese believed that Earth was Square and heaven was round. The altars and palaces were built into circles to represent heaven. The southern wall was rectangular to represent Earth. Chinese show their respect to heaven in Tiantan. The Blue-glazed tiles of the imperial vault of heaven represent heaven.

The circular mound altar is surrounded by a ring of nine plates, which are also surrounded by multiples of nine plates. It represents the supremacy of heaven. Tiantan covers an area of 2.7 million square meters, with an orderly arrangement showing Chinese regality.

天坛是中国古代皇帝祭天的场所。公元 1420 年天坛在北京初建成，皇帝在这里祈求。中国古人认为天圆地方。祭坛、宫殿都为圆形，象征天圆；围墙南部为方形，象征地方。在天坛，处处可见中国古人对天的敬重。皇穹宇顶部的蓝色琉璃瓦象征至高无上的青天。圜丘坛以九乘以九的倍数铺设，代表天无限大。天坛总面积 270 多万平方米，格局严整，尽显中国古代皇家气派。

50 Xi'an Ancient Chinese capital

Located in West China, Xi'an is one of the most notable ancient Chinese cities. More than 3,100 years have passed since it was built. Xi'an is the starting point of the Silk Road. It used to be a commercial hub connecting the west and the Orient during its prosperous period.

Xi'an has the largest bell tower, which was built in the Ming Dynasty. The largest collection of ancient stone tablets and the Terracotta Warriors with a history of 2,000 years. Now it is a rapidly developing modern city. Xi'an is an undying city in Chinese culture.

在中国西部有一座历史悠久的城市，那就是西安。西安这座城至今已经建立 3100 多年。西安是丝绸之路的起点，在它最繁华的时候是东西方贸易的中心。这座城有中国最大的明代钟楼，收藏碑石最多的碑林，2000 多年前的秦始皇兵马俑在这里屹立。这座现代化的城市在飞速发展。西安是华夏文明的不朽都城。

51 Terracotta Warriors

There is a saying that you have not been to China if you have not visited the terracotta warriors (bing ma yong). Located to the west of Xi'an, bing ma yong is a collection of the tomb treasures of Qin Shihuang, the First Emperor of China. They were built by hundreds of thousands of men more than 2,000 years ago. Bing ma yong were a copy of Qin Shihuang's powerful army which conquered and unified the Six States.

Each warrior was as big and vivid as a real soldier. The facial features, expressions. And hairlines of the clay warriors were exact duplicates of real ones. Life-sized war chariots and horses were also made. This army of clay statues is as effective and strong as any real-life military force. When you visit bing ma yong it will remind you of the glorious times of the Qin Dynasty.

有人说，不看兵马俑不算到过中国。位于西安市郊的兵马俑是秦始皇陵的殉葬品。2000 多年前，由十几万人用几十年修建而成，它复制了当年为秦始皇统一六国的强大军队。兵马俑的外形与真实的秦军士兵一样；五官、发纹均按照真人塑造而成，面目表情也各不相同；还有战车与战马也同实物一般大小。这支陶俑做的军队气势恢宏，十分逼真。如今，你来到兵马俑，就能体会到当年秦军的士气以及那个辉煌的年代。

52 Yellow River

The Yellow River, Huang He, is 5,464 kilometers long, ranking fifth in the world. Originating in the Qinghai Tibetan Plateau, it flows east through nine provinces and empties into the Bohai Sea. Sometimes Huang He is poetically called the 'Muddy Flow'. The rich silt carried by Huang He formed fertile farmland that is the birthplace of Chinese culture. The earliest characters, villages, cities and bronzes originated here. Huang He is regarded as the 'Mother of China'.

黄河是一条长 **5464** 公里的大河，也是世界上第五长河。它从青藏高原一路东去，像一条长龙穿越中国九个省区，最后注入渤海。它是世界上泥沙含量最大的河流；富含泥沙的河水淤积成肥沃的土壤，这片流域孕育了中国文明。最早的文字，最早的村落，最早的都城，最早的青铜器均源于此。发展至今，黄河是中国的母亲河。

53 West Lake

Located in Hangzhou, east China, the West Lake, Xi Hu, is praised as 'heaven on earth'. Legends say that a dragon and a phoenix were polishing a pearl which accidentally fell down to earth and became Xi Hu. Some Chinese dramas tell love stories between a fairy and an ordinary man that took place on the banks of Xi Hu. The gods objected to their love and imprisoned the fairy in a pagoda. The pagoda, named Leifeng Tower, is a popular attraction at Xi Hu.

The picturesque Xi Hu is surrounded by elegant landscapes, such as Three Ponds Mirroring the Moon, Curved Yard and Lotus Pool In Summer, and Dawn on the Su Causeway in Spring. As a famous resort, Xi Hu is a perfect combination of artificiality and nature. It looks like a Chinese traditional painting. Xi Hu is often compared to Xizi, the most beautiful woman described in Chinese ancient poems. It is said that, plain or gaily decked out like Xizi, Xi Hu is always alluring.

位于中国杭州的西湖被誉为“人间天堂”。传说天上的一对龙凤雕琢出一颗明珠，它从天而降变成西湖。中国戏曲中，西湖边还曾有过人仙相恋的故事。他们的爱情遭到了天庭反对，仙女被囚禁在一座塔中。这座塔化作西湖一景——雷峰塔。西湖的景观秀丽文雅，三潭印月、曲院风荷、苏堤。西湖是一处人工与自然完美融合的旅游胜地。它像一幅东方山水画。古诗里曾把西湖比作中国古代最美的女人。诗中写道：“欲把西湖比西子，淡妆浓抹总相宜。”

54 Chinese gardens

Gardens are regarded as the treasure of Chinese ancient architecture. The Summer Palace, a grand imperial garden, is a typical Chinese yuan lin. The Chengde summer resort, which showcases natural scenery, was a place for emperors to avoid the summer heat and conduct his court affairs. Ancient yuan lin or Gardens of Suzhou are elegant and classical. Dotted with artificial hills, bridges and terraces, natural landscapes were concentrated in yuan lin. Chinese yuan lin are extravagantly detailed.

中国园林是中国古代建筑艺术的珍宝。颐和园气势宏伟，是中国皇家园林的代表。承德避暑山庄追求自然山水的本色，是皇帝夏天避暑和处理政务的场所。苏州园林景致典雅，小桥流水，亭廊环绕，山石点缀其间；它以小见大，将自然景观浓缩到有限的院落中。中国园林注重细节，处处体现着匠心。

55 Three Gorges

There are three raging rocky gorges on the Yangtze River named the Three Gorges, San Xia. The 192 kilometer-long gorges are nestled in between mountains more than 1,000 meters high on both sides. When you travel through San Xia, water rushes past with old trees and ancient buildings completing the beautiful scenery. It is a breathtaking but pleasant experience. The main part of the key water projects at San Xia on the Yangtze River was finished in 2006. The dam is now able to control floods and generate electric power. The Three Gorges hosts the largest hydroelectric station in the world. The Yangtze River is often compared to a jade pillow and San Xia is a brilliant pearl on the belt.

在中国的长江有三段雄浑险峻的峡谷，它们就是三峡。三峡全长 **192** 公里，两岸耸立着高出江面 **1000** 多米的高峰。穿过三峡，感受到的是汹涌湍急的水流，眼中却是两岸崖壁上青翠的树木，有千年历史的古建筑群，这可是件惊险又惬意的事情。**2006** 年长江三峡水利枢纽工程主体全面竣工，它集防洪和发电为一体；三峡是世界上规模最大的水电站。万里长江如一条飘扬的玉带，三峡就是这条玉带上一颗璀璨的明珠。

Around 2200 years ago a governor of Sichuan found that the floods happened frequently in the rainy season, and water storage was short during the dry season. Therefore based on the geographic features of the MinJiang River, and without doing any damage to the natural environment, he built a special structure dam. The dam is known as Dujiangyan. Dujiangyan functions to direct water and divert floods and sand. Thanks to the dam the region would no longer be plagued by flooding during the rainy season, and water supply will be sufficient in the dry season. Dujiangyan has functioned for more than 2200 years even the earthquake with a magnitude of 8 on the Richter scale in 2008 which happened near the dam, didn't destroy it. Dujiangyan reflects the idea that the land water and people can live in harmony.

2200 多年前，一位四川的地方官发现：当地在雨季洪水肆虐，旱季却无水可用。于是，他根据岷江上游出山口处特殊的地形、水势，在不对环境造成任何破坏的基础上修筑了一座特殊结构的水坝；这就是都江堰。它集引水、分洪和调沙三种功能为一体，使周边地区雨季不再洪水肆虐，旱季不再无水可用。都江堰 **2200** 多年来仍旧正常使用，即便是 **2008** 年那场 **8.0** 级的大地震也没能摧毁它。都江堰体现了土地、水与人在这里和谐共生的观念。

57 Mount Tai

Chinese legends habit that there is a god named Pangu who created heaven and earth. Legends say his head turned into the Taishan Mountain. Therefore Taishan is recorded as the head of China's five mountains. Located in his China's shangdong province. Taishan has witnessed the Chinese history for thousands of years. Chinese ancestors believe that Taishan was a holy mountain which connected with heaven,

because of this, emperors built altars on Taishan to pary for the nation's prosperity and people's happiness. You will experience its steepness when you climb up Taishan. Steps go up the mountain from the foot, the midway goes up to the summit of the mountain, thousands of steps go up the side of the steep mountain. Interesting peaks and trees stand on both sides of the trail. You can enjoy the beautiful sunrise and sea of clouds at the peak of Taishan. In 1987, it was the first Chinese site to be put on the list of world natural and cultural heritage sites by UNESCO

中国古代传说中有位开天辟地的神——盘古。传说他的头部化成了泰山，所以泰山被称为中国五岳之首。泰山位于中国东部的山东省，它承载了中国几千年的历史。中国古代先民认为：泰山是通天的神山；因此中国古代帝王在泰山筑圆坛、方坛，以祭拜天地，祈求国泰民安。登顶泰山，才知道山之险。泰山山体犹如阶梯，中路直达顶峰，数千级台阶沿陡峭的山势向上；沿途密布奇峰与树木，在山顶可以观赏日出与云海的奇妙景象。**1987** 年，泰山被联合国教科文组织列入世界首例自然与文化双遗产。

58 Dun Huang

Dun Huang is an oasis in Northwest China's desert. Since the 2nd century BC Dunhuang had been a crucial stopover for Western and oriental merchants who search for trade and business. According to the old legend, in 366 AD the monk Le Zun passed Dundang which was suddenly overcome with golden lights, as if tens of thousands of Buddhas had shown their presence to the common people. The monk hired workers to dig grottoes.

This is what we called the Mogao Grottoes. The Mogao Grottoes span 1,600 meters and include 492 grottoes with 2,100 painted Buddha figures and murals covering 45,000 square meters. The work on the Mogao Grottoes lasted 1,500 years and reflected the development of Buddhism in China. Dunhuang is a marvelous place where natural wonders and ancient art enchants each other's beauty. Now Dunhuang is considered to be one of the most interesting places in China where overseas travelers must visit.

敦煌是中国西北部沙漠中的绿洲。自公元前 2 世纪以来一直是东西方商贸往来的必经之地。传说在公元 366 年，僧人乐尊路经敦煌，忽现金光闪耀，如现万佛。于是他找人在悬崖峭壁上开凿洞穴、建造佛像，用以朝拜佛祖。这就是敦煌莫高窟。敦煌莫高窟全长 1600 米，现存 492 个石窟，壁画面积 45000 平方米。历时 1500 年修建而成，集中反映了佛教艺术在中国的发展。敦煌是一个神奇的地方，自然奇观与古代艺术遗产交相辉映。如今，敦煌被评为中国最值得外国人去的地方之一。

59 Shaolin Monastery

The Shaolin Temple, shao lin si, is the cradle of the Shaolin martial arts. Legends say that 13 monks who were martial arts experts rescued a besieged emperor, then the Shaolin martial arts became famous all over China. The monks created maneuvers from daily labour tasks joined with their environment.

There are seven yards in shao lin si with a total area of 30,000 square meters. The thousand Buddha Hall is the largest hall in shao lin si. The Pagoda Forest houses the tombs of eminent monks and is the largest building group of ancient pagodas in the world. Kung fu learners all over the world know shao lin si with a history of 1,500 years. The Shaolin martial arts has been gaining in popularity.

少林寺是少林武术的发源地。传说在古代少林寺的十三位武僧救出一位被困的皇帝，从此少林功夫全国闻名。僧人通过悟道修炼，在日常的劳作中创出功夫的招式。少林寺寺院宏大，从山门到千佛殿共七个院落，总面积达三万平方米。千佛殿是少林寺最大的殿宇。塔林是历代少林高僧的墓塔群，是世界上最大的古塔建筑群。现在全世界学功夫的人都知道这座有着 1500 多年历史的少林寺。少林寺正吸引着越来越多的人走近它。

60 Dumplings

Chinese people like eating dumplings, jiao zi, for their delicious taste and auspicious meanings. Jiao zi are made of meat and vegetable filling, and enclosed in a pastry shaped like a half moon. They are boiled in water and eaten with sauces like vinegar. There are hundreds of fillings with different flavors. The shape of jiao zi looks like the ancient currency of China called yuan bao.

People eat dumplings on the Chinese New Year wishing they will earn more money in coming year. There are many steps to make jiao zi. People even like to put a coin into one jiao zi and anyone who gets this coin will be lucky in the coming year. Making jiao zi together with the whole family creates a unique, harmonious atmosphere. Chinese believe that a hot bowl of jiao zi is full of the family's love and affection.

中国人喜欢吃饺子，因为它美味又有着吉祥的寓意。饺子是用面皮裹住肉和蔬菜混合的馅料，包裹成半月形，用水煮熟，配上醋等调料来吃。中国的饺子有几百种馅料，各具风味。因为饺子的形状像中国古代的货币——元宝；所以人们在过年的时候吃饺子，象征着这个家庭在新的一年里有更多的收入。饺子有很多道制作工序，人们还会在某一个饺子中包进一枚硬币，而吃到这个饺子的人在新的一年里会有好运气。一家人围坐在一起包饺子氛围温馨。在中国人心中，那一碗热腾腾的饺子就是家的味道。

61 Beijing Roast Duck

If you come to China, roast duck (kao ya) is a must-have. Kao ya is famous, delicious dish in China with a history of 1,600 years. An authentic kao ya should be roasted delicately in an oven burning fruit wood. The temperature and timing should be strictly controlled. To keep the skin crisp and the meat tender, kao ya should be taken out of the oven after 50-minutes.

A roast duck must be cut into more than 100 slices within several minutes after it has been brought out of the oven. Each slice contains skin and meat. Thin pancakes, Chinese onions, cucumbers and special sauce are used to complement kao ya. Now you have followed us so far, if you still haven't decided to try this famous Beijing specialty. You will probably miss the most enjoyable culinary experience of your life.

如果你有机会来中国，不妨去尝尝北京烤鸭。烤鸭是中国的名菜，已有1600年的历史。正宗的北京烤鸭一定要用果木烘烤，精确控制炉温。烤鸭烤制50分钟后必须出炉，这样才能保证皮脆肉嫩。烤鸭出炉后，必须在几分钟之内切成100多片，要求片片有皮带肉。烤鸭的辅料是薄饼、大葱、黄瓜条、特制的甜面酱。如果看到这里，你还没有决定是否要品尝一下北京烤鸭，那么你也就会就此错过一生中最精妙绝伦的美食体验。

62 Tanghulu

These are crystalline sugar-coated haws, tanghulu, which is a favorite winter snack for children in northern China. Legends say that 800 years ago an emperor's concubine was sick and had a poor appetite. A doctor ordered that she eat 10 haws boiled with crystal sugar before dinner. The concubine recovered within half-a-month. Later, the prescription was passed on to ordinary people. People put haws on a stick and dipped them in hot sugar syrup. The syrup turned into a solid coating, like crystals on the haws' surface. It is a delicious and wholesome traditional snack commonly seen in stores and on streets. The haws are tart and the crystal sugar is sweet. The special taste often reminds us of our happy childhood.

这叫做冰糖葫芦；北方的冬天里，这是孩子们最喜欢的零食。相传800多年前，有个皇帝的妃子病了，胃口不好，一位医生献上药方：用冰糖和山楂煎熬，每天饭前吃上10颗。半个月之后，妃子的病真的好了。后来这种方法传到了民间，老百姓把山楂用签子串起来，蘸上热糖；而热糖遇冷凝固后形成一个水晶一样的硬壳，就成了现在的冰糖葫芦。糖葫芦是种非常美味而又健康的传统小吃，大街小巷随处可见。山楂酸，冰糖甜，那又酸又甜的味道，让很多人想起自己美好的童年。

63 Hotpot

If you want to look for a nutritious meal to share with your family, you should choose hotpot, huo guo. Huo guo has a history of more than 1,700 years in China. To keep out the cold, people pull lamb chops in the boiling pot and ate them. Huo guo ingredients should be selected carefully. Only five parts of a lamb should be used and cut into sheets for cooking. The sauce is composed of more than ten seasonings. The ingredients of the sauce are the commercial secret of hot pot. Huo guo is popular all over China. There are various styles of huo guo. Vegetables and meat can be boiled in huo guo. Sharing hot pot meals of meat and vegetables boiled in savory both with your family is a great experience in the depth of winter. Is huo guo the best choice? Do you want to try it?

如果要寻找适合一家人分享的美食，一定是火锅。火锅在中国有1700多年的历史了。人们为了抵御寒冷，把切成薄片的羊肉放入锅中烫熟。真正精致的火锅对于食材的选择非常挑剔，每只羊身上只有五个部位可以切成肉片；调料由十几种佐料调配而成，每种佐料的比例是火锅店的商业机密。火锅被全中国人所喜爱，发展出风格各异的品种；还可以涮各种蔬菜肉类。在寒冷的冬天，和家人一起吃一顿热腾腾的火锅实在是一种享受。火锅难道不是最好的选择吗？你想试试吗？

64 Tofu

Is there a kind of food that is cheap, delicious and nutritious? Yes! It is Chinese dou fu. Some 2,100 years ago, a noble who longed for immortality developed all kinds of prescriptions every day. One day, he accidentally dropped plaster into soybean milk. The soybean milk curdled into something like pudding. He boldly tested it and found it very delicious. The new dish is what we called dou fu food today. Dou fu is made of soybeans, which are rich in protein. Dou fu can be cooked with fish, vegetables and other ingredients. We can also eat it rare. The easiest way is to put a little bit of chives, oil and salt with dou fu. Dou fu tastes light, yummy and really melts into your mouth. In China, dou fu is quite popular. You can find it on any dining table.

有没有一种既便宜又美味，而且营养丰富的食物。有，它就是中国的豆腐。2100多年前，一位贵族渴望长生不老，他每天研制各种药房。一天，他不小心把石膏碰翻到豆浆中，豆浆凝固成一块白白嫩嫩的东西。他大胆尝试了一下，发现非常美味，这就是我们今天的豆腐。豆腐的原材料非常简单，主要是黄豆，它富有丰富的蛋白质。豆腐可以搭配鱼、蔬菜等食材烹制，也可以生吃。最简单的吃法是放点小葱和油，加上一点点盐，这就是一盘美味的豆腐了。豆腐的味道清淡、入口即化。在中国，每家的餐桌上可都少不了豆腐。

Jiu plays an amazing role in the daily life of Chinese people. Chinese started to brew jiu 6,000 years ago, according to archaeological findings. People have worked hard to improve the process of making jiu for thousands of years. Chinese mainly drink white spirits and rice wine. White spirits are distilled from sorghum or maize. The equipment used for drinking has changed a lot over the course of history. The jiu culture developed with the containers changing from wine goblets to handless cups. As a magical beverage and custom, it has accompanied important occasions, such as weddings and birthdays for more than 6,000 years.

在中国人的生活里，酒扮演着一种神奇的角色。据现有的考古发现，6000 多年前中国人就开始酿酒了。为了酿出最好的酒，中国人一直在探索酿造方法。中国人以饮白酒、黄酒为主。白酒是以高粱、玉米等为原料蒸馏酿制的。几千年来，饮酒器具也在不断变化，从樽到盅演变着中国的酒文化。酒饮与生活习俗紧密相联，陪伴着中国人经历出生、结婚、生子等人生的重要场合已经有 6000 多年了。

66 Noodles

Noodles, mian tiao, are a kind of time-honored Chinese food. Records say that nobles were fond of the food about 30 centimeters long, which is made of flour and boiled in water more than 1,900 years ago. Mix flour with water and make the mixture into a paste, and then cut it into strips. This is how mian tiao is made. Mian tiao can be boiled or fried. Noodles in China also represent preeminence. Therefore, people always have noodles on their birthday to wish for a long lifespan. Noodles are one of the Chinese favorite food, just like the bread for Westerners.

面条是中国的一种很古老的食物。早在 1900 多年前，书上就记载了那时的贵族喜欢吃一种一尺多长的、用水煮熟的面食。面条是用面粉加水做成面团，再加工成条状的食物；可以煮、炒、炸等多种吃法。在中国，面条还有美好的意义；因为它的形状是长长的，所以象征着长久。于是人们在生日的时候都会吃上一碗面条，代表长寿。面条在中国是一种人人喜爱的基本食品，就像西方人离不开面包一样。

67 Fish

The Chinese character yu, which means fish with a plump body and round eyes. Yu is related to special meanings and legends. There was a yu in the Yellow River. Yu wanted to jump over the Dragon Gate, so that he could become a dragon. However, only quite a few yu could accomplish that feat in the turbulent river. People with great achievements in study or business are often compared to these yu who have turned into dragons. Therefore, carps, a kind of yu, represent achieving prosperity through hard work. Yu is a word with the double meaning in China. A Spring Festival painting featuring a yu is a symbol of an affluent life. Yu remind Chinese of prosperity and fortune. Thus, people like to raise yu to pray for good luck. Yu is a produce of nature and a mascot in Chinese daily life.

丰满的鱼身，圆圆的眼睛，这就是鱼字；它在中国有着丰富的含义和传说。黄河里有条鱼，它想跳过龙门变成龙，水流湍急，只有极少数的鱼可以跳过去。后来，人们用这个故事比喻在学业、事业上的飞黄腾达的人。因此有人也把鲤鱼当做勤劳致富的象征。鱼，在中国是一个双关语；年画《有鱼》象征富富有余。中国人看到鱼就会想到富裕和财富，因此人们都喜欢养鱼来增添喜气。鱼是自然之物，也是中国人生活里的吉祥物。

68 Ethnic Groups

It is said that the Chinese nation was created by a female god. She made clay figures and gave lives to them. There are two heroes in Chinese history: the Yellow Emperor and Yan Emperor. Legends say that all the Chinese are their descendants. The Chinese nation is composed of 56 ethnic groups(minzu) with distinct features. The minzu are distributed all over China with their own traditions. Cultural characteristics of songs and dances of the Uyghur, Water-Splashing Festival of the Dai, silver ornaments of the Miao and the Naadam fair of the Mongolian people.

People use 'brothers' to describe their relationship among different minzu. Brotherhood means that different minzu live harmoniously as a huge family.

在中国的上古神话中，一位女神用泥土捏成好多小人，还赋予它们生命。中华民族出两位大英雄叫做黄帝和炎帝；有人说中国人都是他们的后裔，所以中华民族也自称炎黄子孙。中华民族是中国所有民族统称，它包括了 56 个民族；这些民族分布在中国的各个地方，他们都有各自的风俗。维族的歌舞，傣族的泼水节，苗族的银饰，蒙古族那达慕大会，这些都是民族文化的代表。中国人喜欢用兄弟来比喻各个民族之间的关系，意思是说：在中华民族的大家庭里大家都是亲密的一家人。

69 Chinese names An introduction

Chinese names(xing ming) are different from Western ones. The family names(surnames) come first and given names come last. People usually ask each other's 'xing ming' when they meet. If they share the same family name, they believe that their ancestors were relatives. 500 years ago. The family of Confucius is an example of Chinese family names. A young man can trace his family line to an ancestor who lived 2,500 years ago. It is like a tree: leaves, branches and roots are connected by the family name. there are supposedly more than 20,000 family names in China. The secret of where your ancestors came from and what they did are concealed in 'xing ming'.

和西方人的习惯不一样，中国人的姓名是姓在前，名在后。在两个中国人见面的时候会问起对方的姓氏，倘若同姓，两人就会很高兴地说：“咱们 500 年前是一家”。孔子家族是中国姓氏的标本，它可以让一个今天的青年人一代代追溯到 2500 年前的祖先。这就像一颗大树，从一片叶子到根茎，联系他们之间关系的就是姓。据说，中国有两万个姓。祖先从哪里来，为什么来到这里，他们是干什么的，这些秘密都藏在姓名里。

70 Chinese family values

There's a pig and two people. The two people drive the pig into a house and raise it together. Thus making the Chinese character 'jia' which means 'family'. In Chinese daily life, the whole family includes three generations: Grandparents, parents and children live together. Taking care of each other, looking after the young and supporting the parents are the traditional values of Chinese people. You can easily find a typical Chinese jia all over the world.

有一头猪和两个人把猪赶到一间房子里，一起养它。因此，汉字“家”的意思是“家庭”。在中国人的日常生活中，整个家庭包括三代：祖父母、父母和孩子住在一起。互相照顾，照顾孩子，赡养父母是中国人的传统价值观。在世界各地，你都可以很容易地找到典型的中国家庭。

71 Courtyard Uniting Chinese families

A courtyard residence, si he yuan, is a yard enclosed by houses in four directions. It is a closed residence with only one gate leading to the outside. Houses on the north are the largest ones and used as the owners' bedrooms. The arrangement represents the hierarchy in a family. The screen wall stands behind the gate to protect the residents from wind-blown sand. Chinese believe that the screen wall can also ward off bad luck. Therefore, the wall is usually decorated exquisitely. The si he yuan is intended to unite all the family members to enjoy a harmonious and happy life together.

庭院让中国家庭团聚四合院是四合院，四合院是四合院。这是一座近景住宅，只有一扇门通向外面北面的房子是最大的，用作业主的卧室。这种排列代表了家庭中的等级制度。屏风矗立在大门后面，保护居民免受风沙的侵袭。中国人相信屏风还可以辟邪。因此，墙面通常装饰精美。四合院旨在团结所有的家庭成员一起享受和谐和幸福的生活。

72 Hutong Chinese alleyways

Hu tong, a type of narrow street or alley with houses on both sides is the most typical residence in Beijing. The hu tong is not only a traffic channel but also the living area for ordinary people. It

is the most peaceful place in this noisy city. People get along with each other in harmony. There used to be 4,000 hu tong in Beijing with a history of more than 800 years. Many hu tong have been replaced by modern buildings as the city developed. Only a few of them have been preserved keeping the traditions and history of Beijing alive.

胡同，一种两边都是房子的狭窄的街道或小巷，是北京最典型的住宅。胡同不仅是一条交通通道，也是老百姓的生活区。在这个喧闹的城市里，这是一个美丽的地方。人们和睦相处。北京曾经有 4000 个胡同，有 800 多年的历史。随着城市的发展，许多胡同已被现代建筑所取代。只有少数被保存下来，保留了北京的传统和历史。

73 Tulou Building

The tu lou building is a special residence in China. Central China was in a state of war in the 10th century. Large numbers of people migrated to the mountainous region in southeast China. They built tu lou with clay and rocks for living and defense. Circles of rooms are enclosed by another circle. Rooms are connected by round corridors. The second floor is used as a granary. The third and fourth floors are used as bedrooms. There are more than 300 rooms in the largest tu lou, which can accommodate more than 800 people. The center of tu lou is the public area with wells and kitchens. Family meetings are held on the axis. People have lived in the tu lou, cooking, washing clothes, and holding ceremonies for ancestor worship in harmony for hundreds of years. Now tu lou are open to the public. You can experience the family love and unsophisticated customs when you pass by the lovely windows.

土楼在中国是一个特殊的住宅。公元 10 世纪，中国中部处于战争状态。大量的人移居到中国东南部的山区。他们用粘土和石头建造土楼，用于居住和防御，一圈圈的房间由另一圈围起来。二楼用作谷仓，三楼和四楼用作卧室。最大的土楼有 300 多个房间，可容纳 800 多人。土楼的中心是公共区域，有水井和厨房。家庭会议在轴线上举行。几百年来，人们一直生活在土楼里，做饭、洗衣服、举行祭祖仪式。现在土楼对公众开放了。经过可爱的窗户，你可以感受到亲情和淳朴的风情。

74 Chinese tea An introduction

Tea, cha, is the beverage most representative of Chinese culture. Proper etiquette dictates the guests are treated to cha. Many outstanding Chinese poems were created in the company of cha. Originating in China, cha is divided into green tea, black tea, yellow tea, dark tea and white tea, according to its color. The procedures for drinking cha are delightful. Cha, water, wares and fire are indispensable when making cha. The shape, color and fragrance of cha are quite important. The water should be clear and sweet. The fire should be clean without odour. The chinaware and purple clay tea sets are widely used. People feel closer to nature by drinking cha.

茶是最能代表中国文化的饮料。正确的礼仪要求客人受到款待。中国许多杰出的诗歌都是在茶的陪伴下创作出来的。茶起源于中国，根据茶的颜色分为绿茶、红茶、黄茶、黑茶和白蓝茶。喝茶的程序很有趣，制茶的水、器、火是必不可少的。茶的形、色、香是很重要的。水应该是清的，甜的。火应该是干净的。瓷器和紫砂茶具用途广泛。喝茶让人感觉更亲近大自然。

75 Chopsticks Chinese food

Chopsticks, kuai zi, are the most important eating utensils in China. Chinese use them during each meal. They're made of single material with two sticks. They're made of wood or bamboo and use the theory of leverage to pick up various kinds of food easily. Manners are important when using chopsticks just like using forks and knives in the West. Chinese have used kuai zi for at least 3,000 years. They have been spread to Asian countries like Japan and South Korea. The materials come from nature. They represent the wisdom of the Chinese.

筷子是中国最重要的餐具。中国人每顿饭都要使用。它们是由单一材料和两根棍子组成的。它们是木头做的并且用杠杆理论夹起各种各样的食物很容易。就像在西方使用刀叉一样，使用筷子时礼貌很重要。中国人至少使用过 3000 年。它们已经传播到日本和韩国等亚洲国家。材料来自大自然。它们代表了中国人的智慧。

Long, long ago there was a poor scholar who wrote the character 'fu' or 'happiness' on paper and his wife tore the character out. This is the origin of papercutting (jian zhi). The jian zhi craft is considered to be one of the standards to identify a smart woman. People think a woman who is good at making delicate jian zhi is a smart. Jian zhi patterns come from daily life. Clipping and engraving are two skills used to make jian zhi. Intricate centers are important for jian zhi designs. Jian zhi is a popular folk art. Jian zhi expresses Chinese people's wishes for happiness and good luck.

很久很久以前，有个穷书生把“福”字写在纸上，被他的妻子剪下来了。这就是剪纸的由来。剪纸工艺被认为是判断一个聪明女人的标准之一。人们认为善于制作精致剪纸的女人是聪明的。剪纸模式来源于日常生活。剪纸和雕刻是制作剪纸的两种技艺。复杂的中心对于剪纸的设计很重要。剪纸是一种流行的民间艺术。剪纸表达了中国人对幸福、好运的祝愿。

77 Chinese silk and its ancient beauty

A kind of insect called a silkworm produces white, raw silk threads. Chinese people collect these raw threads, create yarn and weave them. The silk fabrics are soft, smooth and light. It is the best material used in making dresses. A si chou dress 2,000 years old was unearthed in a tomb and can be put into a matchbox. Westerners cherish Chinese si chou. It was introduced to Rome around 100 BC by merchants. The route they travelled is called the Silk Road. Compared with other material, si chou is more delicate and light. The clothes made of si chou are the most comfortable. Now si chou clothes are prominent in modern fashions. Chinese si chou has been world famous for its high quality for thousands of years.

中国丝绸及其古老之美 一种叫做蚕的昆虫能吐出白色的生丝。中国人收集这些原始的线，创造纱线并编织它们。丝绸面料柔软、光滑、轻盈。它是做衣服最好的材料。在一座古墓中出土了一件距今有 2000 年历史的泗水连衣裙，可以放进火柴盒里。西方人珍爱中国的“丝绸”。大约在公元前 100 年由商人引入罗马。他们所走的路线叫做丝绸之路。与其他材料相比，丝绸更加精致、轻盈。丝绸做的衣服是最舒服的。如今，丝绸服装在现代时装中占有重要地位。几千年来，中国的丝绸一直以其高质量而闻名于世。

78 Porcelain Ware

When processed correctly, a pile of soil can be turned into an exquisite artwork. Chinaware, ci qi, is a part of daily life in China. The surfaces are decorated with various exquisite patterns. Some are as thin as paper; some are as white as jade; some are as coarse as pottery; and some are as black as lacquer. This is an extraordinary piece of blue and white porcelain made in the 14th century. It was auctioned at more than 20 million pounds. It is the pride of ci qi. Ci qi is still called China in English.

如果处理得当，一堆泥土也可以变成一件精美的艺术品。瓷器是中国人日常生活的一部分。表面装饰着各种精美的图案。有些像纸一样薄；有些像玉一样白；有些像陶器一样自然；有些像漆一样黑。这是一件非同寻常的青花瓷，制造于 14 世纪。它以超过两千万英镑的价格被拍卖，这是瓷器的骄傲。词在英语中仍然被称为 China。

79 Jade More valuable than gold

It is difficult to acquire beautiful jade. Only through the delicate procedure of cutting, polishing and carving a piece of unshaped stone can shine. Yu has played an important role in people's lives in China for the last 8,000 years. Seals of emperors were made of yu. Yu is also a popular material for amulets, and expensive artwork. Yu was featured in the medals of Beijing Olympic Games. Yu represents dignity, holiness and purity. Chinese believe that yu is more valuable than gold.

翡翠比黄金更珍贵 漂亮的玉很难买到。一块未成形的石头，只有经过切割、打磨、雕刻的精细工序，才能闪闪发光。在过去的 8000 年里，俞敏洪在中国人的生活中扮演着重要的角色。皇帝的印章都是用玉做的，玉也是一种受欢迎的护身符。

80 Money Chinese history

Chinese used shells as money, qian, 5,000 years ago. With the developments of metallurgy, metallic currency started to circulate. These copper coins originated from Chinese people's daily life and production. Spade-shaped coins came from farming tools and knife-shaped coins came from fishing gear and knives. The Tong Bao coin symbolizing the titles of emperor's reigns were circulated for the longest time in the history of China. Gold, silver, food and textiles were once used as qian in China. The earliest paper money, named jiaozi, came out in China more than 1,000 years ago. Now the banknotes circulating in China is the 5th edition of renminbi. The appearance and printing techniques have been improved over the years.

五千年前，中国人用贝壳当钱。随着冶金技术的发展，金属货币开始流通。这些铜币起源于中国人的日常生活和生产。铲子形的硬币来自农具，刀形的硬币来自渔具和刀具。在中国历史上，象征皇帝在位头衔的东贝币流通时间最长。在中国，金、银、食品和纺织品曾被用作物品。1000多年前，中国出现了最早的纸币，名为饺子现在在中国流通的纸币是第五版人民币。这些年来，人民币的外观和印刷技术都有所改进。

81 Chinese lantern customs

The lantern, denglong, is the traditional lighting tool of China which also represents merit and joy. The traditional denglong is covered by rice paper with candle burning inside. Lights shine through the gossamer rice paper. Denglongs have diverse patterns. People like to decorate denglongs and paint beautiful and auspicious designs on them. We light several denglongs which symbolize happiness and good luck during the Chinese New Year and enjoy denglong shows with family during the Lantern Festival. Now denglongs are still used in all kinds of celebrations. Denglongs light the night of festivals. Merit and joy spread into different families by these different lanterns.

灯笼是中国传统的照明工具，它也代表着美德和欢乐。传统的灯笼是用宣纸包着，里面燃着蜡烛。灯光透过薄纱宣纸照耀。人们喜欢装饰灯笼，在上面画上美丽和吉祥的图案。在中国新年期间，我们会点燃几盏象征着幸福和好运的灯盏，在元宵节期间，我们会和家人一起欣赏灯盏表演。现在灯笼仍然用于各种庆祝活动，灯笼点亮夜晚的节日。这些不同的灯笼将美德和欢乐传播到不同的家庭。

82 Kites in Chinese folklore

Legends say that the inspiration for kites was a wooden bird flying all day. Most likely, people were inspired by a hat blown off by the wind and invented feng zheng. Legends also say that a general bound bamboo whistles on a huge feng zheng made of ox hide. The kite made horrible sounds to ward off enemies. Other versions say he wrote important messages on feng zheng and sent them to his troops. The military use of kites was just folklore. After all, feng zheng are toys. Classic kites use bamboo, rattan or some other strong, but flexible, wood for the spar; paper or light fabrics such as silk for the sails; and are flown on string or twine. People often make exquisite decorations on feng zheng. Feng zheng have become real works of art. They seem like beautiful paintings flying in the blue sky.

传说风筝的灵感来源于一只整天飞翔的木鸟。最有可能的是，人们受到一顶被风吹掉的帽子的启发，发明了“风筝”。传说还说，一个将军绑竹笛在一个巨大的风筝用牛皮做的。风筝发出可怕的声音来驱赶敌人。另一种说法是，他在风筝的身上写下了重要的信息，并把它们送到了他的部队。这些都只是风筝的民间传说。毕竟，风筝是玩具。传统的风筝用竹子、藤条或其他一些结实但有弹性的木材来做碎片纸，或用丝绸之类的轻织物来做帆；用绳子或飞行。人们经常在风筝身上做精美的装饰，风筝已经成为真正的艺术品。它们就像美丽的画在蓝天中飞翔。

83 Shadow Puppetry A Chinese folk art

A long time ago a monarch missed his deceased concubine so much, he got sick. His ministers reproduced the image of the concubine with cloth and put it behind a screen. The monarch could see the shadow of his concubine on the screen. This was the origin of the shadow puppet (piying).

Pi ying represents interesting stories with lively songs and shadows produced by lights. It is the earliest animated technique in the world. The images are always made of patterned donkey leather sewn with thread. The bodily movements and facial expressions of the puppets are created by bamboo sticks. Pi ying tells stories with traditional methods and is popular all over the world. It features not only interesting stories but also Chinese folk art.

很久以前，一位君主非常想念他已故的妃子，因此生病了。他的大臣们用布复制了妃子的形象，并把它放在一个屏风后面。国王可以在屏幕上看到他妃子的影子。这就是皮影的起源。皮影用欢快的歌声和光影演绎着有趣的故事。它是世界上最早的动画技术。这些图案都是用线缝制的有图案的驴皮制成的。木偶的身体动作和面部表情都是用竹子制作的：皮影用传统的方式讲故事，在世界各地都很受欢迎。它不仅有有趣的故事，而且是中国民间艺术

84 Batik Chinese wax dyeing

Batik, la ran, is a traditional painting and textile dyeing technique with a history of more than 2,000 years. Bee's wax and indigo are two widely used dyes. A steel knife is used to draw patterns on the cloth. A piece of la ran is accomplished after spreading wax, painting, dyeing and washing the cloth. The most interesting part is that various grains form along the cracks of the cloth after cooling. Different grains come from the same patterns: flowers, birds, fish, insects and geometrical patterns on the cloth look mysterious and unsophisticated.

蜡染是一种具有 2000 多年历史的传统印染工艺。蜂蜡和靛蓝是两种广泛使用的染料用钢刀在布上画图案。四片蓝染是在涂蜡、绘画、染色和洗树懒之后完成的。最有趣的是，在冷却后，沿着布的裂缝形成了各种各样的颗粒。不同的纹理来自相同的图案：花、鸟、鱼、虫，布料上的几何图案显得神秘而古朴。

85 Chinese brocade

Brocade is a kind of luxurious silk created over 1,600 years ago. The gorgeous patterns are as beautiful as the colorful clouds in the sky and the Chinese name yunjin. Since the Yuan Dynasty, yunjin has been used for the imperial family's clothes, especially the emperor. Different sizes and patterns indicate different official ranks. It is woven with various kinds of rare silk yarn and feathers. Traditional yunjin is purely handmade on the Jacquard weaving machines. At most, five to six centimeters of yunjin could be produced in one day even with the cooperation of two workers. Now this traditional skill has been modernized and applied to new fashions.

锦缎是一种奢华的丝绸，创造于 1600 多年前。绚丽的图案像天上的彩云，中文名字是云锦。自元朝以来，云锦一直被用于皇室的服装，尤其是皇帝的服装。不同的大小和图案表示不同的官阶，它是用各种稀有的丝线和羽毛织成的。传统的云锦纯粹是在提花织机上手工织造。即使是两个工人一起工作，一天最多也只能生产出 5 到 6 厘米的云锦。现在，这项传统技能已经现代化，并应用于新的时装。

86 Cheongsam fashion

Chinese tradition say that if you want to identify a beauty you should look at her appearance in a cheongsam. The Qipao showcases Oriental modesty and sexiness, wrapping female figures in form-fitting dresses. Fine Qipao are handmade with soft silk and intricate brocade. Selecting fine material is the first step to make a Qipao.

26 dimensions must be measured to make a Qipao and represent the taste of the Master. The collars of Qipao are always curved to show the softness and slenderness of the female's neck. Popular patterns on Qipao include phoenix, birds, leaves and flowers. The breathtaking beauty of Qipao has lasted for more than a century.

中国传统认为，如果你想确定一个美女，你应该看她穿旗袍的样子。旗袍展示了东方的端庄和性感，用合身的裙子包裹着女性形象。精美的旗袍是用柔软的丝绸和复杂的织锦手工制作的。选择好的材料是制作旗袍的第一步。制作旗袍必须测量 26 个尺寸，以体现大师的品味。旗袍的衣领总是弯曲的，以显示女性脖子的柔软和苗条。旗袍上流行的图案包括凤凰、鸟、叶和花。旗袍令人叹为观止的美景已经持续了一个多世纪。

87 Tang Suit Chinese fashion

A Tang Suit (tangzhuang) is not a suit of the Tang Dynasty (618-907) but a suit with Chinese style. Tangzhuang are tailored according to specific procedures. Brocade is the first choice when selecting materials for tangzhuang. Stand-up collars and symmetrical lapels are typical styles. Exquisite embroidery is another feature of tangzhuang. Even the little buttons are made with great detail. These unique buttons are the finishing touches of tangzhuang. Nowadays people put on tangzhuang for the Spring Festival or for weddings. People regard tangzhuang as special clothing for important ceremonies. Absorbing some elements from Western designs, tangzhuang now has a more fashionable, beautiful look.

唐装并不是唐朝(618-907)的一套衣服，而是按照特定的程序定制的中式服装。锦缎是唐装选材的首选。竖领和对称翻领是典型的款式。精美的刺绣是唐装的另一个特色。即使是小小的纽扣也做得非常细致。这些独特的纽扣是唐装的最后一笔。现在人们在春节结婚时穿唐装。人们把唐装看作是重要仪式上的特殊服装。吸收了西方设计的一些元素，唐装现在有了更时尚的美丽外观。

88 Chinese fan

Fans, shan zi, are not only implements, but also works of art and symbols of status in China. Shan zi in scholars' hand represent wisdom and elegance. There are many kinds of shan zi in China. The most typical ones are folding shan zi. Techniques of carving, weaving, calligraphy and painting are applied. Shan zi are not only implements which bring a cool breeze, but also works of art. Collections are cherished by Chinese.

扇子在中国不仅是工具，也是艺术品和地位的象征。学者手中的“扇子”，代表着智慧和优雅。在中国有很多种扇子。最典型的就是折叠扇子。运用雕刻、编织、书法、绘画等技术。扇子不仅是吹凉风的器物，还是一件艺术品。收藏是中国人的最爱。

89 Chinese abacus

Traditional Chinese says that the abacus, suan pan, was inspired by hunters collecting trophies from animals they killed. People began to string wooden beads on wooden sticks to count. This was the first abacus. Invented more than 2,000 years ago, suan pan are the oldest calculators still used today. Most Chinese learn how to use suan pan when they were young. The structure of suan pan is quite simple: It is composed by B, which represent numbers, and wooden sticks, which represent decimals. Suan pan can be used to accomplish complicated calculations quickly with simple formulas and rules. Suan pan are the living fossils of Chinese mathematical discovery.

中国的传统说法是，算盘的灵感来自于猎人。从他们杀死的动物身上收集战利品。人们开始在木棍上串木珠来计数。这是第一个算盘。算盘发明于 2000 多年前，是至今仍在使用的最古老的计算器。大多数中国人在很小的时候就学会了算盘。算盘的结构很简单：由代表数字的 B 和代表小数的木棍组成。算盘可以用简单的公式或规则快速完成复杂的计算。算盘是中国数学发现的活化石。

90. Panda

I'm a panda, xiong mao, the national treasure of China. I like to be alone just like a drifter. Mmmm, bamboo is my favorite food! Our family has lived on the earth for more than 8 million years. At first, we lived on meat. Later, we ran out of food with a tremendous change of the

temperature on earth. We survived on bamboo.

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Now xiong mao are one of the most endangered species. We are regarded as beasts for peace, because we feed on bamboo instead of other animals. A truce was agreed whenever the flags printed with images of xiong mao were raised 1,700 years ago. These flags represent peace and friendship and both sides of the war would stop fighting. Now we're known far and wide, and we're often sent abroad as gifts. We have even been chosen as the mascot of the World Wildlife Foundation. There are only around 1,000 xiong mao remaining in our family all over the world. We hope that people will offer more protection for animals

我是中国的国宝熊猫，我天性喜欢独来独往，像一位独行侠。竹子是我最爱吃的东西，我的祖祖辈辈在地球上已经生活了 800 多万年。很久以前，我们原本吃肉。后来地球温度发生巨变，食物资源短缺，我们靠吃竹子才活了下来，成了世界上最珍惜的物种之一。因为只吃竹子，不猎食其他动物，我们被称为“和平之兽”。在 1700 多年前两军交战中，只要战场上挂起有我们图像的旗，战斗就立刻停止。凡使用熊猫旗，就表示要求和平友好，双方要放下兵戈，停止冲突。现在，我们的名气更大了，经常作为国家礼物被馈赠到外国，被选为担任世界自然基金会的标志物。现在我们熊猫家族在全世界只剩下 1000 来只，我们期待着人们对动物有更多的爱护。

91 Magpie The lucky bird

The magpie, xi que, is a lucky bird in China. Chinese traditions says the chirp of xi que can bring good luck to people. They fly on to the branches of plum blossoms and then to the houses of ordinary people with good news and auspicious omens. A Chinese legend says that xi que gather in heaven once a year to make a bridge for a separated couple. When they gather and form a bridge across the galaxy, the separated couple can meet each other on the bridge. Xi que are kindhearted messengers, people love xi que for their affability, there's a saying that good deeds come with the warbles of xi que.

喜鹊在中国是一种吉祥的鸟。中国传统认为，“喜鹊”的唧唧声可以给人们带来好运。它们飞到梅花枝上，然后带着好消息和吉祥的预兆飞到普通人的家里。中国的一个传说说，喜鹊每年在天上聚一次，为分开的夫妇架起一座桥。当他们聚在一起，形成一座横跨银河系的桥时，分开的情侣就能在桥上相见。喜鹊是善良的使者，人们喜爱喜鹊，因为喜鹊的和蔼可亲，俗话说，喜鹊的歌声中有善行。

92 Chinese Characters Introduction

The marks carved on rocks 8,000 years ago are regarded as the first example of Chinese characters, han zi. Ancient Chinese recorded what they saw in the world by drawing. Legends say that Chinese characters are pictures which can be read. Westerners often say that han zi are pictographs. This is because the first han zi were pictographs which conveyed meaning through physical resemblance to physical objects. Meanwhile, some han zi are composed of symbols which represent sound. Looking back at history, we can understand the life of people they mention China with han zi. There are 2,500 frequently used characters. A good grasp of these han zi is like reading an encyclopedia on China. Welcome to the mysterious world of han zi.

刻在岩石上的标记是 8000 年前被认为是中国文字的第一个例子。古代中国人通过绘画记录他们在世界上看到的一切。传说汉字是可以读懂的图画。西方人常说汉字是象形文字。这是因为最初的汉字是象形文字，通过与实物的物理相似性来传达意义。同时，有些汉字是由代表声音的符号组成的。回顾历史，我们可以了解人们的生活，他们提到中国与汉字有 2500 个常用字符。掌握好这些汉字就像阅读一本关于中国的百科全书，欢迎来到神秘的汉字。

93 Contradiction A Chinese tale of swords and shields

In china they are put together to represent a contradiction. Long, long ago a man was selling his spear and shield. He said that his spear was the sharpest one and could cut through any shield. And then he said his shield was the toughest one and nothing could cut through it. But what would happen if the spear was used to stab the shield? The man couldn't answer the question.

The story tells us not to be caught in maodun. Maodun describes the relationship between things on the opposite positions. 进英语导游备考/从业群加微: ddzls57

在中国，剑和盾被放在一起代表着矛盾。很久很久以前，有个人在卖他的矛和盾。他说他的矛是最锋利的，可以刺穿任何盾牌。然后他说他的盾是最坚硬的，没有什么能穿透它。但是如果用矛来刺盾会发生什么呢？这个人无法回答这个问题故事告诉我们不要陷入矛盾。矛盾，描述的是事物在相对位置上的关系。

94 Carelessness Chinese language

There is an interesting story laying behind Chinese characters like other languages, such as ma hu. A painter drew an animal which looked like a horse and a tiger. He told his first son that it was a tiger. The older son identified a horse as a tiger and killed it. He told his second son it was a horse. The younger boy identified a tiger as a horse and try to ride on it. Therefore, his first son owed a horse to its master and his second son came within an inch of death. From then on, ma hu has been used to describe carelessness.

有一个有趣的故事隐藏在汉字像其他语言，如马虎。画家画了一个看起来像马和老虎的动物。他告诉大儿子那是只老虎。大儿子认出一匹马是老虎，就把它杀了。他告诉二儿子那是匹马。小男孩认出老虎是马，想骑在上面。因此，他的大儿子欠了主人一匹马，而他的第二个儿子离死亡只有一尺之遥。从那时起，马虎就被用来形容粗心大意。

95 Why 'drinking vinegar' means jealousy

'Having vinegar' means to be jealous, chi cu in China. The legend says that a minister was to marry his second wife, according to the order of the emperor. His first wife was quite jealous. The emperor offered two choices for her: if she objected the marriage she should drink poison. The woman willingly drank the poison offered by the emperor. However, she didn't die. What she drank was vinegar, instead of poison. The emperor made the prank to test her attitude towards love. From then on, chi cu has been related to jealousy and used to describe the jealousy between lovers.

“吃醋”在中国意味着嫉妒。传说有一个大臣根据皇帝的命令要娶妾。他的妻子很嫉妒。皇帝给了她两个选择：如果她反对这门婚事，她就喝毒药。那女人心甘情愿地喝下了皇帝提供的毒药。然而，她并没有死。因为喝的是醋，而不是毒药。皇帝做了这个恶作剧来测试她对爱情的态度。从那以后，吃醋就和嫉妒联系在一起，用来形容恋人之间的嫉妒。

96 Bosom Buddy

'Bosom buddy' called zhi yin in Chinese, refers to the friend who knows you best. The ancient story of Boya and Ziqi describes how Chinese define zhi yin. Long, long ago, Boya, who was a master of guqin, a Chinese musical instrument met Ziqi, who was collecting firewood down a mountain. While Boya was playing guqin, Ziqi said "I can hear the mountain singing and the water flowing in your music". Ziqi was only a lumberjack he could tell what Boya wanted to express. When Ziqi died, Boya played his guqin for the last time in front of Ziqi's tomb. Afterwards, people used the quote about 'high mountains and flowing water' to describe friends who understand and appreciate each other. If someone in China says that you are his or her 'zhi yin', it means you are his or her best friend.

“知音”是指最了解你的朋友。古老的伯牙和子期的故事描述了中国人如何定义“知音”。很久很久以前，中国古琴大师巴亚遇到了下山拾柴火的子期。伯牙弹奏古琴时，子期说：“我能听到山在歌唱，水在你的音乐中流淌。子期只是一个砍柴人，他能说出伯牙想要表达的意思。子期死后，伯牙在子期的墓前最后一次弹奏了古琴。后来，人们用“山高水长”来形容彼此理解、欣赏的朋友。如果在中国有人说你是他或她的“知音”，意思是你是他或她最好的朋友。

97 Things Chinese language

In China, the word 'stuff' is composed of two characters representing east and west. When you put east and west together you get a dongxi. Long, long ago there was a well-educated ancient

scholar who would like to ask why. One day he met a friend in the street who was carrying a basket to buy some stuff. He wondered why he was buying dongxi, instead of south and north. It turns out that in ancient China, wood stands for east, gold stands for west, fire stands for south, and water stands for north. We can put wood and gold, not fire and water into a bamboo basket. So, people say they buy dongxi instead of south and north. Thus, dongxi represents stuff.

在中国，“stuff”这个词由代表东方和西方的两个汉字组成，当你把东方和西方放在一起时，你就得到了一个“东西”。很久很久以前，有一个受过良好教育的古代学者，他想问为什么。有一天，他在街上遇到一个朋友提着一个篮子去买东西。他不明白自己为什么要买东西，而不是南和北。原来，在中国古代，木代表东方，金代表西方，火代表南方，水代表北方。我们可以放木头和金子，不能放水火在竹筐。所以，人们说他们买东西，而不是南和北。因此，东西代表物质。

98 Baobei A precious Chinese word

A special kind of shell was collected and used as money by our ancestors. The Chinese character 'bei' was used to refer to the shape of the shell. Later, shells were no longer used as money. The word 'bao bei' is now used to describe the things we cherish. Eventually, bao bei was not only used to describe goods but also people. A child is his parents' bao bei. Lovers also call each other bao bei. Bao bei has become a term to address loved ones.

我们的祖先收集了一种特殊的贝壳作为货币使用汉字“贝”指的是贝壳的形状。后来，贝壳不再被用作货币。“贝贝”这个词现在用来形容我们所珍惜的东西。最后，宝贝仅被用来形容商品，还被用来形容人。孩子是父母的宝贝情侣们也互相称呼对方宝宝“宝贝”已经成为称呼亲人的一个术语。

99 Numerals Chinese Dao philosophy

Numbers, shu zi, have long represented hierarchy order and symbols of nature in China. According to Chinese tradition, Dao produces One, One produces Two then Two produce Three, and Three produce all. Shu zi represents the basic order of the universe. The number of 3, 5, 6 and 9 have even more mysterious connotations in a classic Chinese works, the Book of Changes. The five elements theory summarizes the relationship of five basic energies. Chinese also lay importance to the use of shu zi in designing architectures. Chinese are fond of the mysterious use of shu zi. While digital techniques are well-developed, people never stop trying to solve the puzzles.

数字，在中国长期以来代表着等级秩序和自然的象征。根据中国传统，道生一，一生二，二生三，三生所有。数字代表了宇宙的基本秩序。在中国古典著作《易经》中，3、5、6和9这个数字甚至有更神秘的含义。五行说概括了五种基本能量之间的关系。中国人也很重视在建筑设计中使用数字。中国人喜欢神秘的蜀子用法。尽管数字技术发展得很好，但人们从未停止尝试解决谜题。

100 Ru Yi From back scratcher to lucky Buddhist scepter

What do you do if your back itches? The Chinese made a wooden arm to solve this problem some 1,700 years ago. It had a lovely name, “accomplish on your own”. Later it merged with a jade plank which was used by high officials to make notes when they met the emperor. The new one, named ru yi, which mean “everything goes well” in Chinese, represents power. The head, shaped like a glossy mushroom, and patterns of flowers, bats and ancient coins are carved on the handle. These elements represent Goodwill in Chinese traditional culture. Therefore, it is used in Buddhism as a religious application. If you give it to your friends, it means that you wish them good luck.

从背部挠痒痒到幸运的佛教权杖。如果你的背部发痒，你会怎么做？大约1700年前，中国人制造了一个木手臂来解决这个问题。它有一个可爱的名字，“靠自己完成”后来，它与一块玉板合二为一，玉板是高官们见皇帝时用来做记录的新的“如意”在中文里的意思是“一切顺利”，代表着权力。头部，形状像一个光滑的蘑菇，和花卉，蝙蝠和古钱币的图案柄上有泥土这些元素代表中国传统文化中的亲善因此，它在佛教中被用作宗教应用。如果你把它送给你的朋友，这意味着你祝他们好运